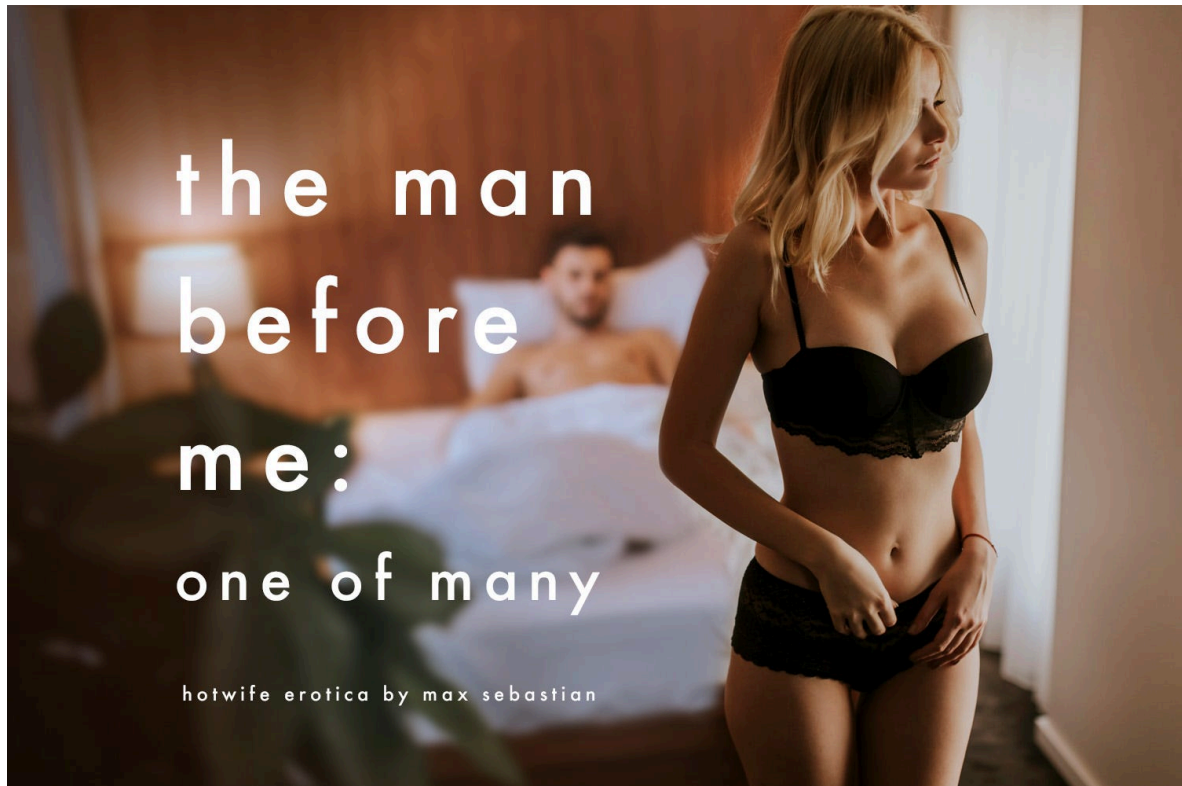


The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch 1-12)

by *Max Sebastian*

The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.1)

by *Max Sebastian*



The thing to say about my wife dating a polyamorous guy was that it progressed in a somewhat sedate fashion.

I suppose we were used to the prospect of Juliette flirting with someone, dancing with someone, and jumping into bed fairly quickly because that was how it had been with her ex-boyfriend, Cory, when he had dragged us into a wife-sharing experience for the first time.

But here we were having dinner with our friends as they tried to set the handsome Ethan up with Juliette, and while the flirting between the two of them was exhilarating, that evening it led only to phone numbers being exchanged.

A few days after that, the two of them had coffee together.

Then, two days later, they had a light lunch with each other, snatched during their lunch breaks.

This was followed by a night out to the movie theater to watch some Oscar-nominated motion picture or other, one with subtitles and everything. But at the end of the movie, the only kissing between them was air-kissing, and then they went their separate ways with the promise of another 'date' soon.

As a husband addicted to the wickedness of an unfaithful wife, I might have expected to feel disappointed by the pace of their seduction.

And yet, despite the slow progression, it was still deeply exciting to me.

When they progressed to evenings out together, I would get to see Juliette getting ready for each date. She did not want to go out with Ethan straight after work, she needed to prepare herself. This meant I could keep her company as she dressed up nicely — and I could see in her underwear choices that she always held out hope that Ethan would be ready to move to a more physical stage, though he seemed to prefer to take things steadily.

I felt so proud of her, my beautiful wife. That other men wanted her so much; that her flirty, energetic outlook was so mesmerizing to everyone around her now that this whole polyamorous thing was out there.

I could wait during their dates, hoping they were having fun and that they might feel bold enough to take the next step in their dating, even though I was quickly conditioned to expect only the smallest signs of progress each night.

When Juliette came back to me, I wanted to know every detail about what she'd done with him — down to whether she'd shared any lingering glances with him. Whether she had accidentally or purposefully brushed her fingers against his arm or something like that.

I wanted to know what she liked about him, how he responded to her, what she hoped would happen between them.

And then, even on days when she did not see him in person, I would get to enjoy how cheerful she was all the time. The little smiles whenever

she received a text message from him, the quiet gasps if their texting ever strayed toward sexting territory.

I couldn't judge all polyamorous people, of course. Everyone is different. But Ethan was very civilized, and his seduction process made me think of nineteenth-century gents prancing around Jane Austen novels — Mr Darcy or Mr Ferrars or Col. Fitzwilliam.

I suppose you could say that the slowness of his moves on Juliette only ramped up the tension I felt waiting for news of progress.

Juliette seemed to enjoy how much it all wound me up. She would tease me by promising to do something wicked with Ethan the next time she saw him — and it would get me hard as a rock. Suddenly, a few words from my sweet wife had the same effect on me as a hit of Viagra might.

When would they finally kiss?

When would they actually have sex?

Meanwhile, our social status as a couple had never been higher.

Suddenly, everyone in our circle of friends wanted to spend time with us — at bars, restaurants, dinner parties, house parties, and whatever. At times I felt a little like some kind of zoo exhibit. People around us were fascinated by the monumental choice we had made. That Juliette could overtly flirt with single guys in front of me — and if she had mutual interest in someone, actually go home with them. That I would happily keep her company and cheerfully socialize with her while she was on the lookout for a rival suitor.

I guess it was a little startling for our monogamous friends, but there was no doubt how chirpy and effervescent Juliette was when there was some good-looking stud to flirt with — and when Juliette was like that, it was a joy for everyone around her.

And people wanted to see how I responded to the sight of my wife openly flirting with other men in front of me.

I didn't mind too much about the scrutiny. If anything, it fit with the voyeuristic nature of our situation. I liked watching my wife flirting with

other guys. I liked our friends being interested in Juliette's 'polyamory', and my support of it. I liked the suspense that seemed to surround us each time we went out with friends and Ethan was there, or when they were actually on a date.

Sometimes I even hung out with our friends while Juliette was on a date with Ethan somewhere else, and it seemed like the whole group was in on the nervous anticipation of wondering whether she would get lucky that night.

To start with, we were nervous about the whole situation as word began to spread far and wide among friends — and family — about Juliette's change of status. We'd done some research, we knew about the attitude some people had towards polyamorous people.

Yet our fears that she would be judged some kind of shameless slut and that I would be ridiculed behind my back for standing idly by while my wife openly cheated on me were not realized.

We had always mixed in fairly liberal circles in New York, I suppose. Whether our friends voted Democrat or Republican, they were relatively progressive socially, accepting people of all kinds. Ultimately, it wasn't for them to decide how Juliette and I lived our lives — and yet it was funny, and wonderfully reassuring, how keen our friends seemed to be for all of this to work out for us.

I've mentioned already that there were great hopes for Ethan to successfully engage Juliette in a relationship. But as things progressed, the question went around as to whether Juliette was open to dating other guys at the same time, and even Ethan was encouraging about her declaring that she was available.

That meant more dinner parties where our friends tried to set my sweet beloved up with other eligible poly or poly-tolerant bachelors.

My God.

There was Oliver. And Jonathan. And Mason. And Brayden.

All sharing their phone numbers with her. Texting her increasingly frequently. Meeting her for coffee. Taking her out for drinks in the

evening. Opening themselves up to the possibility of something sexual happening.

And yet the polyamorous thing made all of them take their time wooing her.

I supposed this was how dating usually was when everyone was single. I'd been married so long, I'd forgotten everything. And not long before I'd met Juliette, I'd been in college, so things had rarely been sedate in seduction.

Man, it was difficult to keep calm whenever we were out with friends, and one or another of her prospective suitors was there, too. Witnessing the chemistry between my sweetheart and a handsome stud she was into was just breathtaking.

Another aspect of this new direction in our lives was that there was always something — or someone — to talk about. How were things going with Ethan, or Oliver, or Jonathan, or Mason, or Brayden? Who was winning the race into Juliette's panties? What did Ethan — or Oliver, or Jonathan, or Mason, or Brayden — really think about her seeing the others?

Who did Juliette like best?

And, of course, was I going to be able to handle it when one of her new relationships finally crossed the boundary into unabashed sexual liaisons?

The race was Ethan's to lose, of course.

I liked him the best. He and Mason and Brayden were the genuine polyamorists among the line-up. Ethan was the most confident among them, and it was with him I felt least awkward socializing with. I also liked hanging out with Ethan's other girlfriend, Brooke, when she was around — though with three boyfriends, she was a busy one.

Ethan and Brooke would often drop useful or interesting little tidbits about polyamory that we would lap up, like the terminology poly enthusiasts had developed.

We learned terms like 'hinge' — someone dating two people, who acted as the join between them. A 'Meta' or 'metamour' — your partner's other partner. A 'comet' was a partner who only came around every now and then. A 'cowboy' or 'cowgirl' was someone who dated a poly person then tried to rope them away into a monogamous relationships. A 'paramour' — a married person's other partner.

There was a whole world of different polyamorous arrangements — or 'polycules' — that Ethan opened our eyes to. 'Parallel' relationships, where metas would be kept separate from each other, each relationship going on independently. 'Kitchen table' polyamory where metas and partners would be comfortable all hanging out around a kitchen table together. 'SoloPoly' people who preferred to live alone.

Anyway. I had my money on Ethan and was just ecstatic when Juliette came home from a date with him one day and revealed that he had finally kissed her — properly.

'And was it good?' I asked her.

'It was *amazing*,' she said, beaming from ear to ear.

Jeez. We were both crazy excited. And it had only been a kiss.

When she came in the door, we were all over each other, clawing at each other while attempting to suck each other's face off. I pushed her up against a wall and my hands were roaming all over her magnificent curves, and I claimed what her evening's date must have been coveting all night.

'He's such a... good kisser...' she said, breathless as I apparently attempted to show that I was, too.

'Was he holding you like this?' I asked.

'Not quite as handsy,' she replied with a mischievous grin, though as I subsequently paused my manual appreciation of her form, she took hold of one of my hands and guided it fairly forcefully between her legs.

She said, 'He did have his hands on my ass at one point.'

I pulled up the hem of her dress and traced the shape of her pussy through her white silky panties, which were absolutely drenched.

'I bet he wanted to fuck you so bad,' I groaned as my fingers slipped inside her underwear and found her pussy completely flooded.

'Oh yes...' she moaned, my digits penetrating her. 'I could feel him pressed against me — he must have a nice big cock...'

'You need to get him to give it to you,' I said, kissing her soft neck as I thrust my fingers into her, stroking the upper echelons of her pussy, where I knew she liked it.

'I don't want to rush him...' she teased. 'But I don't think he can hold out much longer...'

My sexy wife fucked my mouth with her tongue while I fingered her. It felt so filthy — it really wasn't something she would have done through most of our marriage. She'd become a vixen between the sheets, her self-confidence soaring ever since she'd been re-awakened to the way other men wanted her.

I dropped to my knees, peeling down her panties, appreciating the sight of her pussy framed by garters she had chosen with the hopes of seducing her polyamorous prince.

I wedged my face between her taut thighs, lapping at her juicy sex, savoring her sweet nectar.

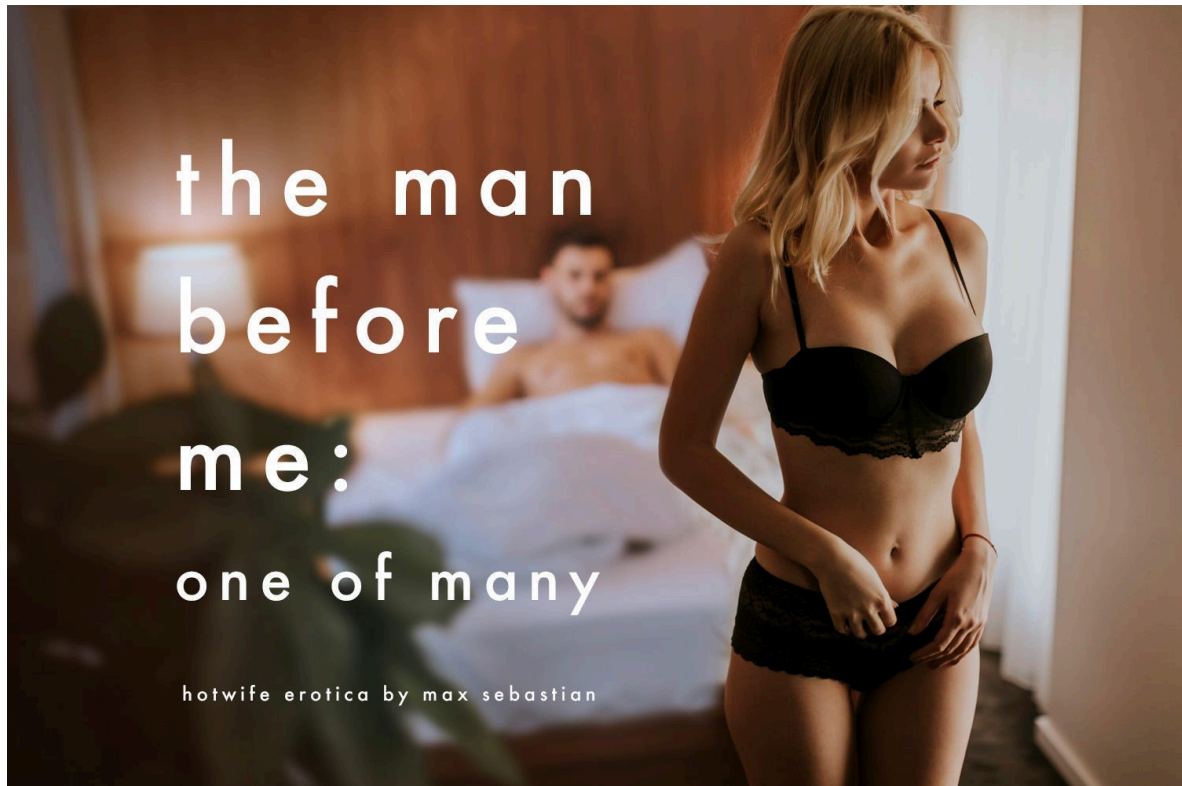
I couldn't escape the fact that the more attention she got from other men, the more I craved my gorgeous wife. She closed her eyes and groaned as I slipped my tongue inside her, as I pressed my mouth over her clit, as I rubbed her pussy with my face.

Even if we didn't quite see ourselves as actual polyamorous people, it seemed that the new poly phase of our marriage was going to be a real thrill ride.

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The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.2)

by *Max Sebastian*



On evenings when she wasn't going out on a date, I would come home from work to find that Juliette was already home before me. She had started improving her scheduling and work efficiency so she could get home earlier at the close of play — for one main reason.

'Oh good, you're home at least — come here honey, I really need it...'

'Of course, sweetheart, just let me hang up my jacket.'

I liked to get home a little later in the evening now, give her a little time to herself, time to relax and unwind, and get to texting all the hot guys she'd been desperately trying to avoid all day so she could get work done.

Then, by the time I was there, she would be lounging on the couch, already touching herself as she chatted with her suitors on WhatsApp.

'Who you talking to?'

'Ethan. He's telling me how good it feels kissing me.'

We could talk about her date plans coming up, more details about a date she'd just been on, or what was going on in any of her boyfriends' lives. There was so much to chat about these days.

'You should tell him how good it feels fucking you.'

'I'm getting there... he's not a pervert like you, honey...'

Kneeling in front of her, peeling down her panties, which were already wet and creamy from a day of trying but failing to think about all the guys who wanted to fuck her.

Reaching up to give her a little soft kiss on the mouth in greeting, feeling her affection and gratitude in that sweet gesture before she giggled and sat back, lifting a knee to spread her thighs so I could get to work while she returned to texting other guys.

Relishing the sight of her bare pussy, her pink folds glistening with her dew, so aromatic after an office day spent dreaming of other men.

Teasing her a little with the tip of a finger, trailing her oily moisture around her sex, nudging her little clit.

Ducking down to slide my eager tongue along her slippery groove.

'Ethan wants to get together with Brooke and one of her other boyfriends.'

'Us?'

'She likes you, you know that? She's sweet.'

Only half my mind devoted to actually talking with her, much of my focus going on lapping at her sweet pussy, gorging on her copious juices, sucking on her delicious sex. I had become addicted to the flavor of her arousal. I think my brain had connected her taste to an overall sense of joy and well-being, and now I was hardwired to perceive it as my own personal narcotic.

'We've told her I'm not really into dating other people.'

'I think they feel that if we all get together, it'll all start to click.'

'Seems like it's clicking okay already.'

'Then we'll all feel comfortable about me going all the way with Ethan.'

I loved the way she moaned as I feasted on her, texting one-handed with her boyfriend while using the other to tousle my hair. Occasionally forced to pause her communications with the outside to pull my head firmly against her sex to up the pressure.

'They need to feel comfortable about it?'

'You know Ethan's been on his own for a while. He had a bad break-up.'

'Oh, he did?'

'Poly people have bad break-ups too, you know.'

It wasn't just Ethan — we talked about all the men in her life like that, my nose resting on her mound, my lips to her labia, my tongue slipping inside her. Fucking her with my mouth while she fantasized she had another man's cock inside her.

I had to admit I enjoyed hearing about all these other people's lives while I snacked on my sweet Juliette's snatch.

It was like catching up on your favorite TV series while giving in to an urge for some highly delectable candy.

'And Brooke would bring her other boyfriend when we all go out, as well?'

'I think she wants to show us how normal dating multiple people is. They see us as complete beginners. We need to be reassured everything's okay, none of it's a big deal. We just hang out, shoot the breeze, and then go home and have sex.'

'They would go home and have sex. And you would go home and have sex with Ethan. So that would leave me as the third wheel... wait, *fifth*

wheel?'

'The point is, you'd be there to see how straightforward it is for me to date Ethan.'

I teased her a bit, sometimes. The truth was, I was keen to witness any part of Juliette dating Ethan, whatever opportunity I could get. I didn't intend to date another woman — partly because it wasn't really our deal, but also because it struck me what a lot of work it would involve, getting to know someone else and focusing on another woman. I felt I needed to focus on Juliette romantically, although it turned out I did enjoy hanging out while she was being romantic with others.

'We should invite Brian and Jessie,' I suggested. 'Maybe we could make it look like I'm open to dating Jessie.'

'And then Brooke would lay off you?' Juliette giggled.

'She wouldn't feel like she has to try and convert me.'

I had lunch with Brian, and mentioned that Brooke and Juliette were planning a night out with Ethan and me — and Brooke's other boyfriend, Zach.

And when I joked about inviting him and Jessie out with us all, to distract Brooke from her efforts to persuade me to get into the poly groove, he didn't dismiss the idea as merely a joke.

'Jessie loves how everyone's treating Juliette now this whole poly thing has come up,' he said.

'Oh, right?'

'The acceptance that you guys have, even when Juliette's flirting with other guys around other friends.'

I nodded. 'I like not having to hide things from them,' I said. 'And... weirdly, how interested they are in her dating other people.'

'And they set her up with nice guys?' Brian laughed.

'You could have Jessie talk to Brooke... and then word would spread... and then maybe Jessie would have as many guys after her as Juliette does.'

I could see the interest in his eyes as far as that idea went. It was surprising at first, but the more I thought about it, the more sense it made.

'I'll talk to her about it,' he said earnestly. 'She is intrigued about how you guys have gone public.'

'I like it,' I shrugged. 'It somehow emphasizes that she's fulfilling my fantasy right in front of me... And encourages her.'

Brian grinned. 'I can tell how hot it is for you when you see Juliette all flirty with the guys when we're all out in a group.'

'It's a little weird,' I said. 'But good weird. I don't think it would be the same if our friends weren't such amateur anthropologists.'

'It's New York,' he laughed. 'Everyone wants to know about everybody else. Especially if they're doing something different.'

'Everyone's always worried other people are doing fun stuff that they haven't thought of yet.'

'You still have to be careful mentioning it to people outside... you know... our particular sphere,' he warned.

It was true enough. While our friends treated the polyamory thing as just another kind of lifestyle that could be pursued without it turning us into the forces of darkness, there were plenty of people out there who viewed it as just as distasteful as something like cuckolding.

Mainstream society wasn't exactly au fait with people dating more than one person at a time. There were some who viewed it as an out-and-out threat to the concept of marriage, or even a danger to society.

'We've kept Juliette's poly status away from work,' I told Brian, and he agreed it was wise, at least for now.

'It complicates things, particularly since you guys both work at the same firm.'

I nodded. 'Even if we didn't, though, it's probably better to keep that kind of thing outside our professional circles...'

There was an odd flash of something that passed across Brian's face — like he knew something he wasn't entirely sure he wanted to reveal to me.

He paused for a brief moment, considering whether to tell me. Then he seemed to relax, deciding it was better to just let me in on the secret.

'Jessie's met someone at her work,' he said quietly, glancing around to double-check there were no spies in our midst.

'She has?'

He was blushing. It seemed to confirm that this was something big for them.

'Just a load of flirting at work so far, but they have had coffee together a few times.'

'Very exciting.'

'It has to be secret, though, even if we tell our friends that Jessie's going poly. Because they'll really get fired if anyone finds out.'

'Pretty strict HR rules, huh?'

'Yeah. I mean, they might not get fired but... strongly encouraged to leave.'

'Do you know much about the guy?'

'He's a little older than us, but he's not in her department, so it's not like she'd be accused of trying to get some kind of promotion by sleeping with him.'

'Not that you'd object if she did,' I laughed.

'No, I wouldn't object,' he said, sharing my laughter.

'Does he know she has a boyfriend already?'

'They haven't talked about it — I mean, it's really not gone much further than him hitting on her, and Jessie responding positively to his interest. But I think if she gently let slip that she's poly...'

'Maybe it would help navigate that particular issue?'

He nodded. 'They can't date openly anyway. They'd be better treating it like an affair.'

'And he's not married?'

'Divorced,' Brian said. 'But only once. They haven't talked about why yet. I'm not sure Jessie really cares too much.'

I nodded. 'She's not here to fall in love with him.'

'Exactly.'

I was so pleased for my friend. The vibe I got from him was that this was really happening. That he couldn't have been more thrilled about the prospect of his sweetheart embarking on a fling with someone at work.

But that wasn't the only exciting news Brian had for me at that particular lunch meeting.

As we were finishing up, he had an unexpected question for me.

'I was wondering, Nick...'

'Yeah?'

'If... uh... when... I ask her to marry me...'

'Yeah?' My heart paused mid-beat.

'Would you be my best man?'

I caught my breath briefly. 'Seriously?' Then, 'Absolutely! Oh my God — you're popping the question?'

A little flushed with self-conscious anxiety, he said, 'I know it seems a little soon... but I've never been so sure...'

Wow. I was so happy for him. And I knew Jessie well enough to know she was likely to say yes, even though they'd only been dating a matter of months. She was very keen to become Brian's official hotwife, and that included accepting a ring from him.

Back home, I could tell Juliette about what Brian had said about the suggestion of him and Jessie coming out as poly — and joining us on a night out with Brooke and Ethan and Zach.

I could also mention the guy Jessie had met at her company — but Juliette already knew about him.

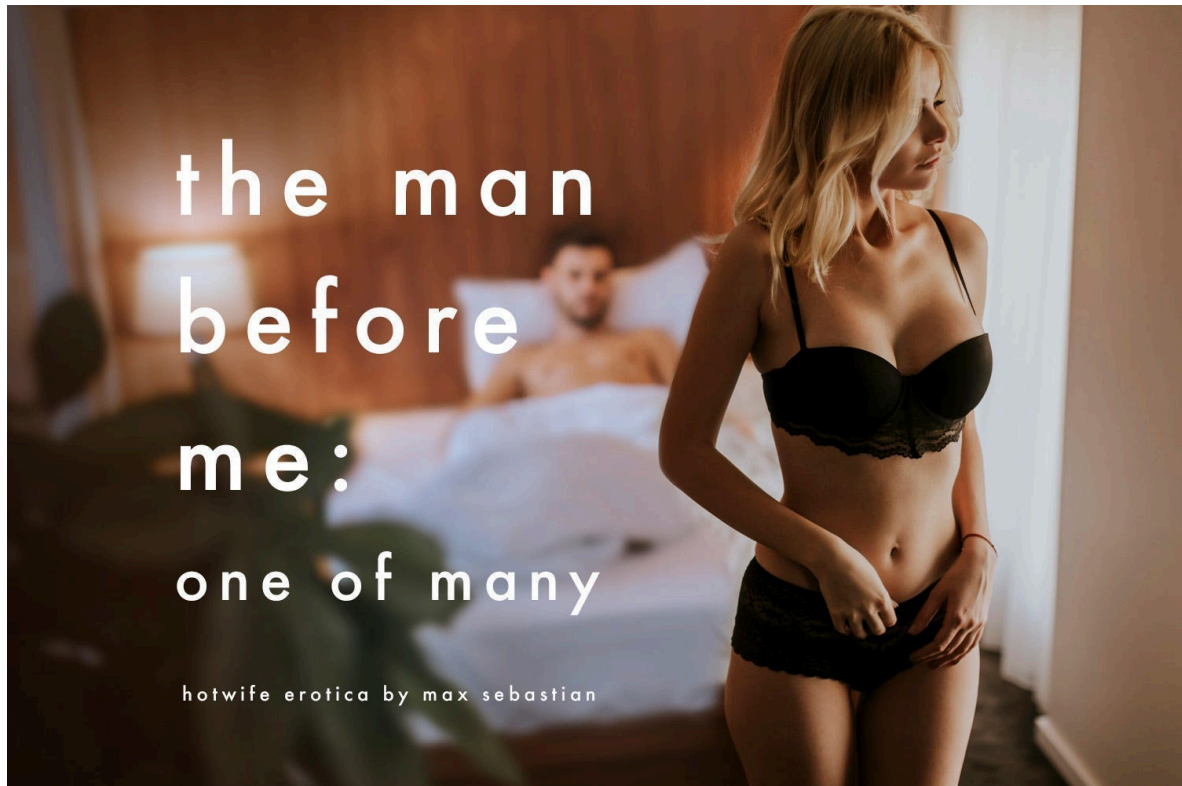
'She showed me a picture,' she said. 'He's a pretty hot guy. Jason.'

But for now, I couldn't share Brian's biggest news about her BFF. He hadn't even picked out the ring yet.

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The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.3)

by *Max Sebastian*



Saturday came along, and then Brian and Jessie came over to hang out with us during the afternoon so that we could all spend time together before meeting up with our new poly friends later.

Our two BFFs were in an excellent mood — they had discussed the idea of Jessie coming out as poly in the same way Juliette had. After considering the possibilities, Jessie was now quite excited about the idea.

'It makes a whole lot of sense,' I said. 'I mean... if anything ever slips out about her being with some other guy...'

'It's just who she is,' Brian smiled. 'Not really a scandal.'

'Unless it's with Jason from work, of course.'

'Yeah, we'll still have to be careful about him. But she does like him a lot, so...'

'Exciting times, huh?'

Brian and I were lounging on the couch watching baseball on TV while the womenfolk were deciding on what to wear for our night out — Jessie planning on borrowing one of Juliette's outfits since they were practically the same size.

I said, 'Brooke will be pleased, huh? If Jessie joins the movement.'

Brian grinned. 'Yeah. She's a bit of an evangelist, huh?'

At this point, Jessie emerged from the bedroom wearing only a bra and panties, her blonde hair up in curlers. 'Hey, I hear you need some protection from her tonight,' she said to me as she dropped down to sit on the couch next to me like she needed a break from the exhausting task of choosing what to wear.

I laughed. 'Well... I'm not sure I need protection. But she's not going to stop hounding me until I'm seeing at least someone other than just Juliette.'

Jessie giggled, enjoying how helpless I was to keep from ogling her in her underwear. 'You should just let her convert you,' she said.

'Let her?'

'Yeah — give her the win. Then you can ask me out... and she'll stop bugging you, right?'

'Uh... I guess...'

I glanced at Brian, who gave me a kind of hey-it-might-work shrug. He seemed to like the sight of Jessie getting close to me on the couch in just her underwear. As though she sensed her boyfriend's enjoyment of it, Jessie pulled herself close to me, practically curling up on my lap, saying, 'I'm going to enjoy dating you, Nick.'

She put a hand on my chest and leaned in to kiss my mouth. Well, it would have been rude not to respond.

I ran my hand down her body as I made out with her, appreciating her curves while offering Brian a little show. Jessie climbed properly onto my lap to make out with me, and I had to admit I enjoyed it. She was beautiful, you couldn't deny that, even if my heart belonged to Juliette.

Speaking of, my wife emerged from the bedroom and joked, 'Hey, Jess, you're supposed to wait until Brooke's converted him before you get to have him.'

Jessie giggled and pulled herself up from my lap. 'Yeah — I suppose I do.'

Juliette was holding up a couple of different outfits, demanding Jessie's opinion. The two of them disappeared back into the bedroom to discuss, leaving me sitting there with a hard-on, still smelling her perfume on me.

'So how long are we planning on keeping up the pretense that I'm dating Jessie?' I asked Brian.

'As long as you like,' he said, sounding completely chilled about the whole thing. 'I mean... there's no need for term limits, right?'

'I guess not.'

'People'll get used to you guys dating... and then... it won't matter either way after a while.'

By the time we were ready to head out for the night, Juliette and Jessie looked fantastic, of course, donning cute summer dresses that you might have imagined were a little too small for them, except that's how they were supposed to be.

We met the others at a small basement restaurant down in Hell's Kitchen. Here was Ethan, his eyes practically popping out as he took in the sight of Juliette.

Here was Brooke, looking pretty devastating herself in a tight pair of white jeans and a strappy top that left her midriff bare and her cleavage on show.

And there was Zach, one of Brooke's other boyfriends, whom she had brought out with us all to distract from his other relationship troubles. Zach seemed very nice, though from the get-go, he seemed constantly on his phone, frantically texting or calling one of his other girlfriends.

'I'm sorry,' Brooke said to me quietly over dinner. 'Tonight was supposed to be about showing you how chill and normal the whole poly thing is, but Zach's new girlfriend is suddenly having cold feet about him seeing other people.'

'She didn't know he was poly when she started seeing him?' I asked.

'Oh, she knew. She seemed cool with it at first, but... you know, sometimes people think they can handle it, and it turns out they can't.'

'You think she'll turn cowgirl?'

Brooke laughed, 'Getting the hang of the lingo, huh?'

While Zach was somewhat preoccupied dealing with his other other-half, Ethan was focusing most of his attention on Juliette as we ate dinner — and afterward at the bar we eventually moved on to. That left Brooke with Brian, Jessie, and me, but we all had plenty to talk about once we mentioned that Jessie was poly too.

The big surprise — at least for me — was that Brian told Brooke that he was poly, too, though he was only dating Jessie at the moment.

It meant that Brooke flirted with him plenty — all night — but she didn't feel the need to evangelize with him about breaking out of monogamy. I wondered why I hadn't just revealed myself publicly as poly as well in the first place. Ah well. Brian was cunning that way.

While she flirted with Brian all night, Brooke's primary focus was on me.

She seemed fascinated by me, that I was apparently monogamous, but couldn't keep my eyes off Juliette while she was flirting — and occasionally kissing — Ethan. I tried to conceal how closely I was monitoring Juliette and her new man, but the trouble was that it was such a thrill. Difficult to tear my eyes away when they were sucking face.

But Brooke seemed to notice everything.

'You're monogamous, but you're not jealous she's making out with another guy?' was her near-constant refrain.

'I don't need to be jealous,' I would explain. 'She's the poly one, right? She won't leave me for someone else, because she doesn't need to. She can have both of us.'

'But that means you are poly,' she insisted. 'It's just you're part of a triad.'

I shrugged. 'That depends on how many guys Juliette wants to date,' I grinned.

After dinner, we moved on to a bar two blocks away, and I slowly gave in to Brooke's argument that I was also poly. I held out long enough that she wouldn't suspect I had planned on doing so at the beginning of the night. Sure enough, once she felt she had secured victory in our little debate, she no longer felt the need to try to convert me.

But now her focus turned to why I was so fascinated by Juliette's progress with Ethan — and whether I might be persuaded to try dating more than one person.

'You're not going to get cold feet about her, if she seals the deal with him?' she asked me.

'Oh, no,' I said confidently.

'Do you like him? Ethan?'

'Yeah — he seems really nice.'

'You're happy she's dating him?'

'Of course.'

She was leaning into me at the table, trying to analyze my eyes, desperate to work me out. It meant I had a superlative view of her cleavage, even if I wasn't more taken by the sight of Juliette steadily seducing Ethan.

Brooke didn't only focus on trying to work me out.

She got on very well with Brian and Jessie. She was keen to hear how Jessie had been a hapless serial monogamist for so long before meeting Brian, who had allowed her to get in touch with her true nature. Brooke seemed quite impressed with Brian, and how he had encouraged Jessie to break out of the mono mold.

As the drinks flowed, Jessie was getting increasingly flirtatious with me — joining in with Brooke to persuade me of the benefits of not limiting myself to one partner.

I looked to Brian for support, but he was enjoying himself too much to come to my aid — watching closely as Jessie flirted with me more and more, and made it clear to everyone that she had the hots for me.

I don't know. I guess it was pretty fun. Later, we all moved on to a nightclub — though Zach, poor guy, had to leave to tend to the crisis in his relationship with the cowgirl Kate. I mainly wanted to watch Juliette dancing with Ethan, though it was nice getting to dance with Jessie and Brooke.

At one point, Brooke got me on my own at the bar and asked me whether I had noticed that Jessie was completely crazy about me.

I smiled, feeling all warm inside that our little plan was working. Soon, I would claim that Brooke had successfully won me over, and then I would ask Jessie out, and then my wife's new metamour would no longer feel the need to persuade me to date other women.

I just had to play things carefully so Brooke wouldn't realize she was being played.

'Jessie's great,' I said. 'I mean... we've been friends for years. You know — pretty much since I first met Juliette.'

Brooke had a real fire in her eyes. 'She's wanted you for ages,' she said. 'You know that? You can see it in her eyes. The way she looks at you.'

'She's in love with Brian. She's crazy about him.'

'You still don't get it,' Brooke grinned. 'Just because she's crazy about Brian, doesn't mean she doesn't get to be crazy about someone else, too. That's how it works.'

I felt the natural compulsion to disagree with her, to persuade her she was wrong. But now I glanced over at Jessie, who looked so beautiful under the lights from the dancefloor, and remembered that I was supposed to be letting Brooke succeed. I was supposed to move towards a situation where I could ask Jessie out, and pretend to publicly date Jessie, so that I could hide in plain sight in this new poly world in which we found ourselves.

I said to Brooke, 'It's hard to... you know... get your head out of the whole monogamous thing.'

She nodded. 'Society has completely brainwashed people for millennia.'

Right now, Jessie was chatting with Juliette and Ethan. She glanced over her shoulder and saw me looking at her, and she flashed me a dazzling smile.

I suddenly felt something deep inside my chest, a lurch of realization.

Did Jessie really like me? Like... beyond the whole pretending thing?

Surely not. The whole point was... we were all just putting on a show so Brian and I could enjoy sharing our wives. Or in Brian's case, his soon-to-be fiancée. Juliette and I had had some fun with Jessie and Brian. We had all swapped partners — but that had been about practising the art of hotwifing. To get Jessie used to being with other guys while remaining in love with her primary, Brian.

'Maybe I could... try dating Jessie...' I said, not quite sure what was going on here. 'You know... if Juliette's okay with it...'

As we watched the other group, Juliette tore herself away from them, leaving Ethan chatting calmly with Jessie and Brian. God, my wife looked so gorgeous. Even in the colored, flashing lights of the nightclub, I could see she was all flushed from her dancing — and from the excitement of seducing the handsome Ethan.

As she drew near, I could see the flames of desire in her eyes and knew she was ready to take the next step with Ethan.

Man. My heart was racing. I felt so giddy and light-headed.

Even before she opened her mouth, I knew that Juliette was about to tell me that she and Ethan were getting out of here. She was going to give me that last chance to declare any reason why she should not be joined in lust with her new man.

'Hey,' she said, a trifle breathless.

'You're going to head out?' I prompted her.

She gave the bashful smile of someone admitting her attraction to someone new. 'He wants me to take him back to our place,' she said.

I felt my stomach fold over. Wow. Even now, after everything we'd been through, it was still dramatic as hell to know that my wife was about to go somewhere and sleep with another man.

'Of course,' I said, smiling as I realized I had nowhere to go that night. The assumption was that Ethan would not expect me to return to my place, where he was sleeping with my wife.

Juliette looked at Brooke. 'It's... okay with you?'

Brooke initially seemed confused, wondering why Juliette would ask her permission to sleep with her boyfriend. But then she was all smiles, declaring, 'Of course, of course!' Before stepping forward to give Juliette a congratulatory hug.

Adding, 'Have fun, you two! Don't do anything I wouldn't do! Which is probably not much of a restriction...'

But then Brooke suddenly stopped and turned serious. 'Juliette?'

'Yes?'

'Your sweetheart of a husband wants to ask Jessie out.'

Juliette glanced at me and flashed her eyes. 'Well, it's about time!'

Well, now I was confused. We were still talking about the plan for me to pretend to date Jessie, weren't we?

'You see?' Brooke asked me. 'She's okay with it.' Then, to Juliette, she said, 'Tell him how crazy about him your friend is.'

Juliette gave me a funny look. When I say funny, I don't mean in a ha-ha way. It was deep and meaningful, precisely when it really shouldn't have been.

She said seriously, 'She's been crazy about you ever since she's known you.'

And it was like... wake up, Dude.

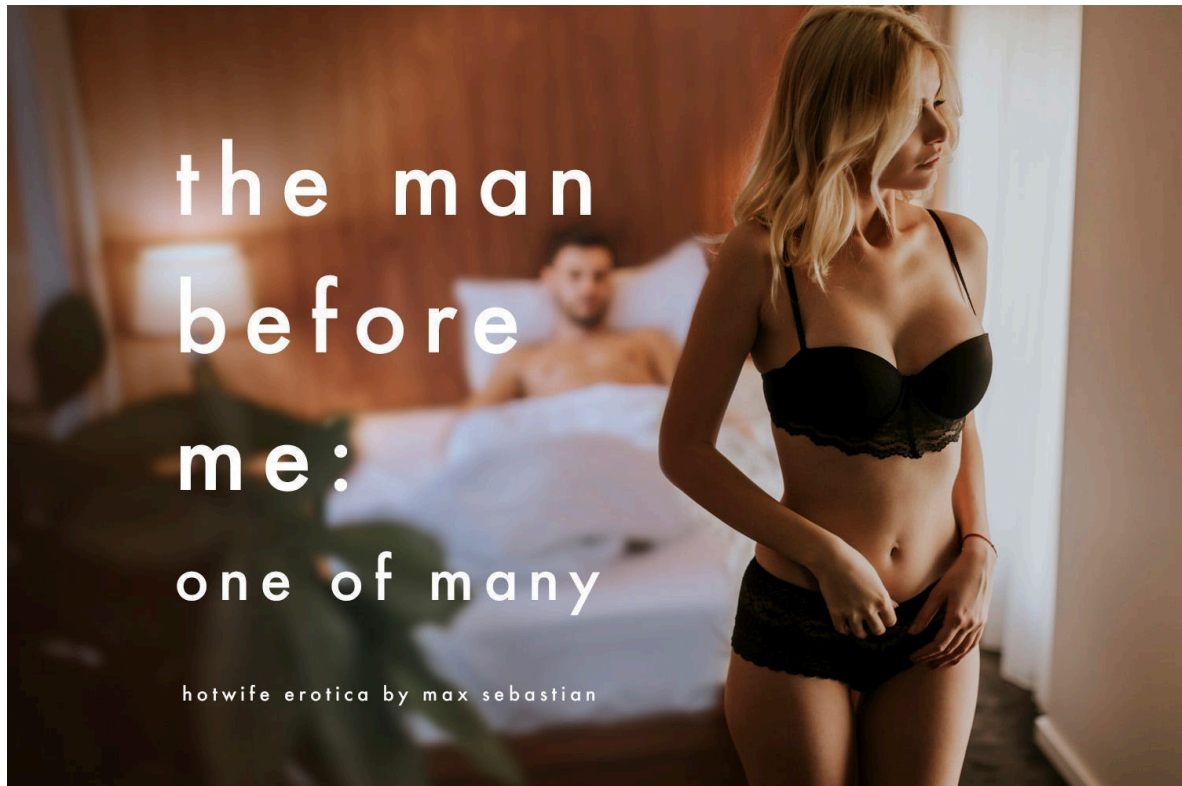
I scratched my head, and without really thinking about what I was saying, blurted out, 'But... what about Brian?'

Juliette's face cracked into a beautiful smile, and she joked, 'He's been crazy about you ever since he's known you, too!'

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The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.4)

by *Max Sebastian*



I went out onto the street to watch Juliette get into a taxi with Ethan for the ride back to our apartment with him.

It felt different from anything that had happened to us before.

This wasn't Juliette slipping away to bang an old boyfriend. It wasn't my flirty wife fooling around with my best friend while we all partied together. This was my soul mate officially — and publicly — dating another man. And now she was taking him home to our place to seal the deal.

'He's a nice guy, huh?'

Brian had come out to check on me.

I gave him a cautious smile. 'Yeah, I like him. I think he'll be good for her.'

I could see in his eyes he recognized what a big deal it was for me, even though Juliette had been through the whole sharing caboodle before with Cory, her old flame.

He said, 'We weren't planning on doing the whole poly thing, were we?'

'No,' I said, trying to keep an eye on the yellow cab as it disappeared into the distance, though it was difficult to track as it merged into all the traffic. 'It just kind of happened.'

'You can still think of it in the same way we'd hoped it would go.'

'I suppose I can,' I said. It had started to rain, as though to emphasize my sudden somber mood. 'Although under the circumstances, I think Ethan is under the impression he's free to fall in love with my wife if he wants to.'

Brian nodded. 'Wasn't Cory under that impression?'

'I think we played him the wrong way.'

'Do you think Juliette still has feelings for him?'

'Probably. I thought we could just avoid them.'

Juliette and Ethan's taxi finally disappeared. I felt the panic rising inside my chest, and knew it was the feeling of losing control over the situation. It was just my instincts, my body reacting to the sight of my wife going off with another guy.

At the same time, my cock was thickening up just to think about them spending the night in private together.

'Maybe the poly folk have it right,' Brian said. 'You know... that it doesn't necessarily matter if she falls in love with more than one person. As long as she stays committed to you.'

I nodded, and we started walking back into the club. 'Maybe. Does that mean we're poly, you and me?'

He grinned. 'The boundaries are somewhat blurred.'

As we descended, I decided just to straight-out voice my confusion about everything. I said, 'I think I'm supposed to pretend to ask Jessie out now.'

Brian's eyes flashed. 'I think that's the plan... but maybe you don't need to pretend.'

I looked him in the eyes. I knew he was waiting for the right time to ask Jessie to marry him. Was this changing environment making things complicated for him? For them?

He was blushing. 'We're practically a polycule already, aren't we? You and me and Jessie.'

'And Juliette,' I added.

It felt good, thinking about us that way. I hadn't really talked to Juliette about that, but that's how it just felt. And how she had reacted to Brooke ordering me to ask Jessie out... well, that wasn't pretend.

Brian patted me on the shoulder. 'Come on,' he said. 'She's waiting for you.'

Jessie was hanging out with Brooke at the bar, looking like a million dollars.

Brian walked over to them, and as they saw us, Jessie's face lit up, her eyes latching onto mine.

'Hey. Everything okay?'

'Yeah — Juliette went home with Ethan,' I said.

'And you're feeling okay about it?' Jessie asked me. I tried to look her in the eyes. Had she been wearing a top with such a plunging neckline before? Man, it was difficult to tear my eyes away from her cleavage.

But as I locked my eyes on hers, she seemed so wincingly beautiful that it made me feel a touch of guilt, too.

'I guess I need to get used to this whole poly thing,' I smiled.

'It's a little different, isn't it?' she said. I noticed that Brooke — and Brian, for that matter — had disappeared. The two of them had just melted away into the shadows to leave us some privacy.

I gazed into her eyes. Man, I'd forgotten the power of connecting with someone when you both wanted to take things to that dangerous next step together. And Jessie did, very obviously, want to take things to the next stage with me. My legs started feeling a little shaky.

'I think I'm supposed to ask you if... you know... you'd like to go out for coffee sometime,' I said.

She giggled. 'And I think I'm supposed to be absolutely delighted you asked, and then immediately accept,' she beamed.

I tried to respond with the same kind of brightness. I wasn't used to flirting with people. I had forgotten what kind of signals you're meant to give them along the way.

I said, 'I'm not entirely sure... you know... how quickly you're supposed to move when you're dating someone poly.'

'I think you're supposed to move as quickly as you need to,' she said. 'Juliette didn't know Ethan all that well, so it took a while...'

'So, how quickly are we supposed to move? I mean... since we already know each other.'

Jessie's eyes flashed. 'I don't think we have to wait nearly so long,' she said. 'But maybe... we can make it seem to our friends that we're taking things steadily.'

We looked around, noticing that we were now on our own — Brian and Brooke had properly gone.

I asked her, 'Have you and Brian talked about this?'

She nodded. 'He likes having you around. He likes how you make me feel.'

I said, 'I don't want to get in the way of you two.'

'That's how this poly thing works,' she smiled. 'There's no getting in the way. You just have to communicate properly.'

I spotted Brooke on the far side of the nightclub, chatting with Brian while trying not to look as though she was spying on me and Jessie. Our eyes connected, and Brooke flashed me a smile and gave me an encouraging little wave. I gave her a little smile back, amused at her.

I said, 'I haven't really talked to Juliette. Not beyond... you know... the original plan. Pretending.'

Jessie laughed. 'She's the one who suggested to me we do it for real.'

'She did?'

'She feels bad about you being on your own when she's with somebody else.'

'But it's not supposed to be about that — '

Jessie shrugged. 'That's how she feels. Back when we were in college... well, we were just a natural extension of each other.'

I watched Brooke ushering Brian out of the nightclub, as though she was worried that the fact I'd spotted her might interfere with my asking Jessie out. Brian was laughing about being shooed out of the establishment. As he glanced over at me and saw me watching, he grinned and gave me a wave — before giving in to Brooke's pressure to leave.

'So... Brian's going home?' I asked Jessie.

'He'll be okay,' she said. 'He's enjoying this as much as we are. Come on — dance with me.'

We danced together, and it was so much fun. Of course I'd danced with Jessie before over the years we'd known each other, but this seemed different. We were together. We were allowed to be together.

I saw her in a new light, and vice versa. We flirted, we ogled each other, we brushed up against each other. We openly lusted after each other.

When the music slowed down, we held each other and pressed up against each other. And after a while, we were pressing our lips together and wrapping our arms around each other, and thoughts of doing any more actual dancing had faded.

Then we were in a taxi, on the way back to the apartment in Brooklyn she shared with Brian. Making out on the back seat like teenagers.

'You think he'll be awake?' I asked her in between sucking on her lips with free abandon.

'Probably. You know how much he enjoys this kind of thing.'

It's funny how different this felt. I'd fucked Jessie before, in front of Brian. I shouldn't have been nervous. But tonight I was with Jessie under different circumstances. We were publicly dating now. Tonight, we were crossing a different line.

'Do you think Ethan's nervous about going all the way with Juliette?' I asked. 'You know... the fact that I know about it?'

Jessie smiled. 'He's probably not nervous about you knowing about it.'

'Because he's poly?' I said, kissing her soft neck. God, she smelled good. It was kind of floral, but with a hint of vanilla that emphasized her sweetness.

'He's done this before, hasn't he? When you're properly poly, you can probably compartmentalize relationships. You don't need to think about your partner being with someone else.'

'Unless you want to.'

She smiled, and I felt her hand moving to my lap, seeking out and finding the hardness I was stowing. 'But that's the thing, isn't it? We're not really poly.'

'Aren't we?' I laughed. 'At what point do we cross the line?'

'Are you still thinking about Juliette going off with Ethan?'

'Of course.'

'And how do you feel about it?'

I paused, trying to ascertain my feelings. 'Hopeful... excited.'

'You're looking forward to seeing her again, as soon as she's done with him? So you can find out what happened... enjoy the details she gives you about fucking him...?'

'Sure.'

'I bet Ethan's not looking forward to the next time Brooke sees one of her other boyfriends. He's not hoping to find out the dirty details of how she fucked Zach the next time it happens.'

'No, he doesn't strike me as that kind of guy either, but different poly people have different desires.'

Jessie squeezed my cock through my pants. 'Well, it doesn't matter what we are,' she said. 'Our friends think we're poly. Let them. They still want to be our friends, so that's the main thing. I just know that we're going to have a lot of fun together... and my sweet boyfriend will enjoy the fact that I'm sleeping with somebody I really want...'

I felt a ripple of pure jubilation as she said that. The way she looked at me.

'...and I'll know as I'm fucking you that it's really turning him on,' she went on. 'You know that I'll be thinking about him while I'm fucking you, and you're okay with that — because you'll be thinking about Juliette fucking Ethan.'

In the darkness of the taxi, I cupped one of her breasts, feeling that strange desire — strange because she was my friend, and had been for ever, but now I was allowed to be attracted to her, allowed to touch her, allowed to appreciate her beauty.

'I suppose it doesn't really matter what we are,' I said.

'We can learn a lot from our new poly friends — like the need for good communication,' she said, and I saw her pull out her phone to tap out a

text message for Brian, letting him know we were in a taxi, on the way home.

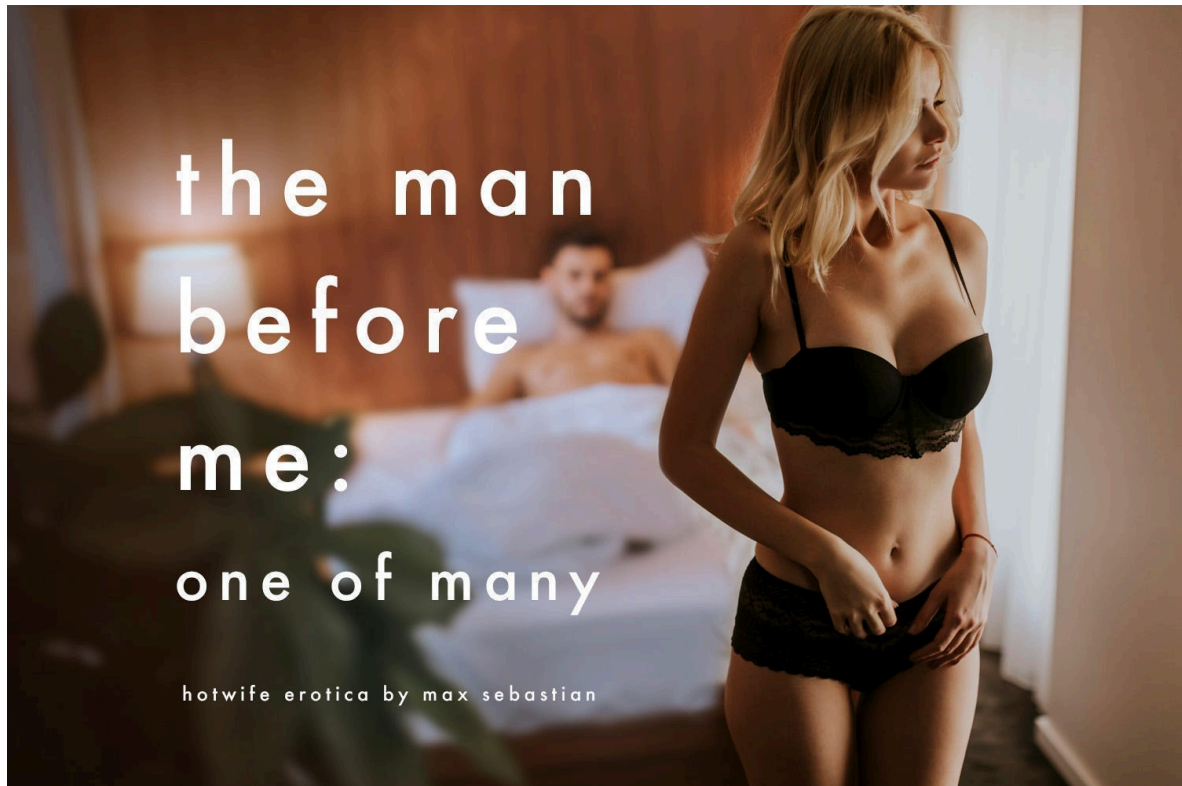
Almost unthinkingly, I pulled out my own phone. There was a message waiting for me from Juliette:

Have fun with her, my darling. She's had a crush on you forever. There have been times over the years when I almost gave in and let her share, like we did with guys back in college. But you know, I thought you'd think I'd been a slut before I met you. Or that I didn't treat our marriage seriously. Then, when you wanted me to sleep with Cory, I got freaked out and scared that you wanted to leave me. And then you said you had no interest in other women. Well, Jessie's like my other true love. If we're going to play poly, I want it to be her. I'm nearly home now. Can't wait to have Ethan inside me. And to see you after xx

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The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.5)

by *Max Sebastian*



'Where's Brian?' was the obvious question when we reached their apartment and it was clearly empty.

Jessie smiled. 'He's hanging out with his new buddy Brooke.'

'He's dating Brooke now?'

'No, I don't think they're dating,' she said, stepping into the kitchen area to open the fridge. 'They're just hanging out. You know that poly people aren't just constantly on the lookout for more dates?'

'Yeah,' I grinned. 'It's easy to get carried away with this whole thing.'

Bearing a bottle of chilled white wine, Jessie offered me a glass that I gratefully allowed her to fill for me.

She said, 'I think Brooke's got more than enough on her slate at the moment, and Brian's told her he's happily exploring things with me and doesn't feel the need to branch out at the moment.'

'Seems like you guys have talked all this over,' I said, clinking my glass to hers before sipping the crisp Sauvignon Blanc.

She smiled. 'We've talked a lot. You know... first, it was about what Juliette was doing, telling everyone she's poly. And then it seemed like a good idea for us to have a cover story like that, too. And then I was talking to Juliette, and the whole thing about me pretending to date you came up...'

'And when did you decide to date me for real?'

She smiled. 'We're not great at pretending things,' she said. 'I mean, me and Brian. And Brian was like, if we dated for real, it wouldn't make much difference anyway. We have slept together.'

'Well, I'm not sure slept is quite the right way to put it.'

She smiled and put down her wine glass before turning to me to drape her hands over my shoulders and push herself on tiptoes to kiss my lips.

The wine tasted a lot sweeter when it was on her lips.

'You know it would have been okay if he wanted to hang out here,' I said, fizzing at being alone with this gorgeous woman. 'You know... with us.'

Jessie giggled. 'I think he wants to give us the chance to connect, just the two of us.'

She pressed her mouth to mine, and I enclosed her in my arms. My hands seemed to fall naturally to her behind, but at first, it felt like an accident, that it was inappropriate for me to touch her there. This was my wife's best friend.

But she moaned as we continued to kiss, and my hands swept over her body, taking in her trim figure, her tantalizing shape, moving up to her chest.

She broke our kiss to give me an encouraging smile as my hands reached her breasts.

She slipped her tongue into my mouth. I couldn't help but compare her to Juliette. Somehow, kissing her seemed dirtier, naughtier. I guess it was like it was forbidden because she wasn't my wife; she was my wife's bestie.

I nudged the strap of her dress off her shoulder and bared one of her breasts. It startled me a little to see, even though I'd seen her naked before. This was different, somehow. Tonight was a whole other ballgame.

I tugged up the hem of her dress, though it might have seemed a little fast. It was really just to show to myself that I could. That I was allowed. I caught my breath as I laid eyes on her panties — a white lace thong that was almost sheer in places.

She gave me a mischievous smile — both amused and delighted by my lust for her. Her hand grabbed my wrist, guiding my hand down to lodge it between her thighs, up against the lace of her only piece of underwear.

I could feel how wet she was. The heat of her sex through the thin fabric.

'Things'll get confused,' I warned, feeling a pressure deep down — that tickle of guilt, that caress of unease.

'Things?' Her bright expression faltered.

'Feelings,' I said.

'Not confused, realized,' she insisted, clamping a hand over mine, pressing my fingers against her smoldering pussy.

'We're friends...' I said.

'Always,' she breathed.

'And Brian...?'

I couldn't help myself. She was so beautiful. And with Juliette's approval, I couldn't resist her. Yet I felt a continuing anxiety about giving in to my

desires.

She smiled. 'Brian is the most wonderful man I ever met. And I couldn't have met him without you.'

I nodded, feeling relief sweep through my veins.

'Is that what you're worried about?' she asked me. 'That we'll start dating, and I'll forget about Brian?'

I shrugged. 'I guess... I don't want to do anything that could — '

She shook her head. 'You're still stuck in a monogamy mindset. I know... it's difficult to break out of, but you just have to avoid thinking about limitations.'

I kissed her soft neck, 'I get it.'

'None of this replaces what I have with Brian. And none of it replaces what you have with Juliette.'

'No,' I said, slipping the other strap of her dress off her shoulder, allowing the material to slip down to expose her other breast as well. Her pink nipples were so stiff.

'It's all in addition to what we already have,' she beamed, wrapping her arms around my neck, my shoulders, pulling me in for a deep kiss.

I picked her up as we sucked on each other's mouths. She squealed with delight as she left the floor and moaned as I carried her into the bedroom to lay her on the bed.

'Brian's going to ask me to marry him,' she said.

I was surprised, but I thought perhaps she was talking in vague terms — from a general sense of how their relationship was going.

I nuzzled into her neck, enjoying the sweetness of her fragrance, the warmth of her velvet skin. 'You sound pretty certain,' I said, pretending I knew nothing.

She chuckled. 'He's been looking at rings,' she said. 'You know, doing the research.'

'He has?' I was surprised she knew. That he'd told her, despite leaving me the impression he was going to pop the question only when he had chosen a ring.

She grinned. 'He thinks it's all a secret. He keeps deleting his browser history, and so I won't know. But you can't delete everything. I borrow his iPad, and there's advertising on Google for engagement rings...'

'No such thing as privacy anymore,' I opined, kissing my way down to her magnificent breasts.

'Has he said anything to you?'

'If he did, I'm sworn to secrecy,' I said.

Her eyes lit up. I hated to ruin the surprise, but I fear Google took the real blame.

She said, 'You won't tell him I know?'

'I fear I'm not the best keeper of secrets,' I laughed. 'You have to pretend you don't know anything.'

'Of course,' she said, moaning as I sucked on her nipples. 'Oh God, that feels so good...'

I asked her, 'How do you feel about marriage?'

She smiled. 'I'm so happy. Marrying a guy like him. It'll be incredible.'

I reached up to kiss her lips, feeling the excitement, the joy quivering throughout her entire body.

'Are you happy for me?' she asked me.

'Very,' I said. 'You couldn't be marrying a nicer guy.'

'Because if we're in a relationship, I'll need your approval to marry someone else.'

I laughed. 'You know you have it.'

It was so weird to talk about being in a relationship with her. If we'd been both single, it would have been way too early to talk about things like that. This was sleeping together on our first date — even before our first proper date. You didn't talk about relationships, marriage, at a time like that.

But we felt like we were making the rules up as we went along.

Jessie's phone bleated, and it made her giggle while I was sucking on her gorgeous tits. 'It's probably him.'

'Aren't you going to read his message?'

She flashed her eyes. 'I'm not supposed to be looking at my phone at a time like this.'

'You can, though.'

She reached for her purse and kissed my way down her body, moving between her legs, running my face along her shapely thighs, inhaling the scent of her arousal emanating from her damp panties.

'He's just checking in,' she said, laying back to look at her phone.

'He's with Brooke?' I planted kisses along the edge of her panties, teasing her, teasing myself.

'Yeah — he's crashing on her couch. That guy Zach came back for a late-night booty call, so...'

She let out a long, deep moan as I kissed her through her panties, tasting her dampness through the thin lace, feeling the heat of her sex.

I said, 'Give him a little treat.'

'A treat?'

'You know... a few details about what we're up to.'

'Oh,' she said, her eyes flashing.

I tugged aside her panties to reveal the exquisite sight of her pussy. Hairless, just as Juliette had it, glistening with her dew.

She gasped as I pressed my mouth to her sex, as I tasted her. Her hips began moving in gentle circles as I licked her there, as I sucked on her pink petals. Her leg curled over my shoulder, her foot pressing against my back.

'Oh God...' she moaned.

She tasted so good. Lying back, her stiff nipples pointing at the ceiling, she gasped and sighed as I pleased her with my tongue. It was too distracting for her to finish her message to Brian.

But she came and then seemed to remember where she was.

'What should I tell him?'

'That I'm about to fuck you,' I said.

'Mmmm....' She purred. 'I like the sound of that...'

It made me wonder what Juliette was up to at that moment. Had she done the deed with the handsome Ethan?

Jessie offered herself up to me on all fours, but I stood on the floor and pulled her knees toward me so she was kneeling on the edge of the mattress as I entered her. I figured it gave me more scope to power into her.

She was a gorgeous sight to behold — a little more curvy than Juliette, though otherwise they were very similar in height and complexion, with all that beautiful blonde hair.

She was so tight as I squeezed into her wet pussy, and she made cute little noises as my hard cock filled her.

'Uh... uh... oh my God...'

It felt so good as I gripped her God-given ass as plunged into her, her body rocking as I powered into her, her breasts jiggling. And she was so

wet I couldn't believe it — dripping as I fucked her. I turned her over onto her back, and her inner thighs were slick with her wetness.

I swear, before long, it was like she'd wet the bed.

'My God, what was that?' she said, gasping for breath.

'You came again?' I laughed.

'Yeah, but... that was different. It wasn't ever like that before.'

I picked myself up, slipped out to fetch wine. I probably should have fetched water instead — we drained the bottle in no time.

'You have a big cock, Nick Morrison,' she giggled, and I could tell the wine had pushed her beyond a certain point of inebriation.

'If you say so,' I laughed. 'I'm not sure Juliette would agree, comparing me to her ex.'

'Yeah, but there *is* such thing as too big, you know that?'

'You had some that were too big?'

'Uh-huh. Back in college. Well, Juliette kinda liked them that way. But I prefer it when I can get them in my mouth.'

As though to prove it, she leaned forward and slipped my cock into her mouth. She might have come a few times already that night, but I'd held out. I wouldn't be able to hold out with much more of this, however — she was hella talented, oral-wise.

I said, 'When you and Juliette shared guys... did you ever do it at the same time?'

'Threesomes? Sure, sometimes. It got pretty wild. Didn't Juliette tell you?'

I felt my cock throb in her hands as she said that. The thought of my sweet wife and this gorgeous minx sharing a guy in a threesome made my pulse race.

'Mmm, you like that, huh?' she grinned, feeling my cock responding to her words. 'Me and Juliette double-teaming hot guys?'

'Sure. Juliette was always a little cagey talking about you and her sharing guys.'

'It was pretty slutty,' Jessie giggled. 'When we were in Freshman year, the hot guys were sophomores — or seniors. We discovered that our ability to sleep with the really hot ones increased exponentially if we offered them a threesome.'

'Man...' I said, thinking about my Juliette as a college girl, teaming up with Jessie to fuck big-dick jocks.

Jessie sat on my lap, taking my hard cock back in her juicy pussy. She said, 'I wonder what Tony Jones is doing nowadays. Or Benjamin Sanchez. Or... God, what was his name?'

Without letting my hard-on slip out of her sex, Jessie reached for her phone again, searching for the name of the guy she'd forgotten. It didn't take her long to track him down.

'Mark Essen, that was it. He had a crazy big dick.' She showed me the Facebook profile of a guy who looked like one of those guys on YouTube who sell manly supplements.

'Nice,' I chuckled, enjoying the sensation of Jessie slowly rocking back and forth on my cock.

'Oh, and he made Juliette squirt. I never saw anyone else ever do that with her.'

'He made her what?'

'Squirt.'

'That's a myth, isn't it? Just a porn thing.'

Jessie smirked and shook her head. 'You notice how damp these sheets are, mister?'

Well, that made my eyebrows rise. 'Seriously?'

She grinned. 'Doesn't happen very often. Actually, I wasn't sure I still could. But apparently, you, Mister Man, can make me squirt.'

Well, that was a revelation. 'And this guy... Mark... he made Juliette squirt? Was it more than once?'

'Whenever she fucked him.'

'Did he do that with you?'

She gave me a playful, jokey frown. 'He didn't exactly fit inside me,' she said. 'We shared him a few times, but then Juliette dated him on her own after that. At least until he moved on. They're migratory, guys like that, you know. Oop... I just friended him.'

'Is he single at the moment?'

'Hmm... says here... divorced.'

'Sweet. Maybe you and him — and Juliette could have a reunion sometime.'

Jessie giggled again. Then she gasped. 'Oh, look — he just friended me back! You think he even remembers us?'

'Are you kidding? You had a threesome with him.'

Jessie gasped again. 'He just messaged me!' She read the guy's message: 'Hey Jessie! Long time no hear. You still hang out with Juliette?'

We looked at each other, and I could tell she was thinking the same kind of thing as me.

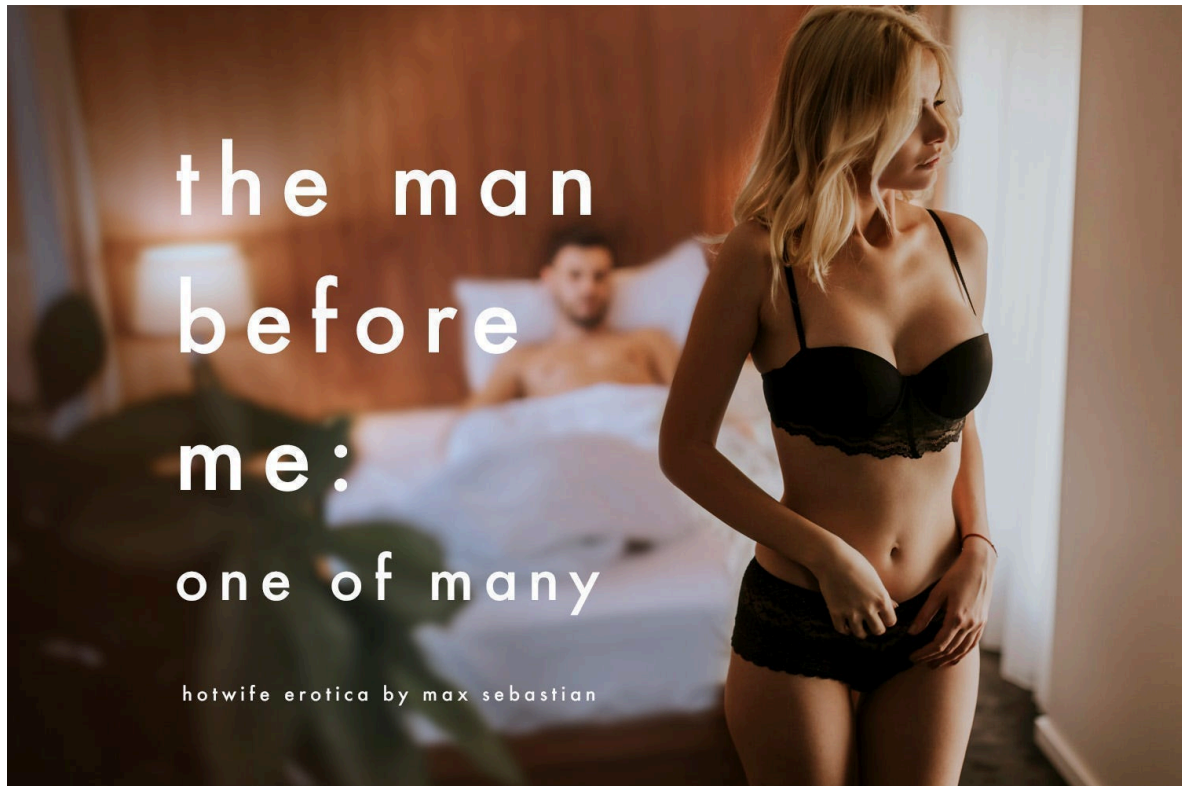
'Tell him,' I urged her.

Her smile broadened. 'Juliette's going to go crazy if I tell her I've been in touch with Mark Essen.'

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The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.6)

by *Max Sebastian*



Juliette was sitting at the table, breakfast in front of her, texting one of her other menfolk as I returned home in the morning. It seemed somehow very civilized. She didn't look like someone who had just had a sex date with a man who wasn't her husband.

'Hey.'

'Hey.'

'Good time with Ethan?'

'Uh-huh.'

I fetched myself some juice, trying to keep calm. I guess I was disappointed she wasn't all over me, trying to wow me with details about

being fucked by her handsome polyamorous date. But I felt I needed to keep my disappointment in check.

'Good time with Jessie?' Juliette asked, but it sounded more like she was being polite than that she really wanted details.

'Yeah, it was a lot of fun,' I said, acting casual as I stood and gulped my cool apple juice.

Juliette was wearing what appeared to be running clothes — tight lycra shorts and a thin hooded top that left her somewhat eye-catching midriff bare. Her golden hair was brushed and tied in a long ponytail.

'You been for a run?'

She turned and smiled. 'Ethan wanted a run around the park first thing this morning, so.'

I raised my eyebrows at the guy's discipline. 'Nice,' I nodded. There was a pause where I didn't really know what to say, and Juliette was just texting whoever it was.

Releasing the big question that had been dancing on the tip of my tongue, I said, 'So did it... happen?'

'Did what happen?'

'You know... sex.'

She turned around, leaning on the back of her chair to tell me, 'We had a very nice night together if that's what you want to know.'

There was an unexpected edge to her voice.

'You have a problem with me asking?'

She sighed like I was stubbornly ignoring a long conversation about this that we hadn't, in fact, had. 'I can't just tell you everything about me and Ethan,' she said. 'I thought you understood that. This is different.'

'Different how?' I felt the hot acid of marital conflict swamp my stomach.

'I'm dating a polyamorous guy — and I'm trying to respect the rules of being polyamorous.'

'There are rules?'

She seemed to be fighting the urge to give me a full eye roll. 'There are ethics, yeah. Like there are in monogamous dating, except with more people involved, it gets a little more complicated.'

Sigh. I didn't want to get into an argument about any of this. 'But you are my wife; he's got to expect you'll tell me something about what happened?'

'If I was your daughter, and I'd just spent the night with a guy, would you expect me to — ?'

'Oh, so I'm your father now?' I said, trying to lighten my tone so we might avoid actual anger here. 'Hey — if I had a daughter, she wouldn't be spending the night with a guy until they were married with at least two kids.'

Juliette smiled at that, thankfully. 'Okay,' she said, 'so imagine you're my best friend, and not my husband, and — '

'If I was your best friend, I would have just fucked me last night. Which would be weird.'

She giggled. 'You have fun with Jess?'

'Oh, yes,' I grinned.

'Anyway. If you were my best friend, I wouldn't give you details about my night — '

'You used to tell Jessie everything,' I pointed out, walking out to the living room. 'You used to share guys.'

'This is different, can't you see that?' she said, surprising me by getting up and coming after me. Had she thought I'd stormed off just now?

She grabbed my hand and stopped me. 'I can't go behind his back and tell you personal stuff — at least until we talk about all this stuff. I like this

guy.'

She was so hot in her running gear. She had that slightly flushed, gently perspired look fresh from her run, but it could also have been from sex, so it turned me on like crazy. I breathed in that lightly musky scent from her exertions and felt the arousal blooming inside me.

'So you like him, huh? That must mean he has a big dick,' I joked, but it fell flat.

'He's a really nice guy,' she said sweetly.

Man, I got the sense that Ethan had converted her to Mormonism or something. She seemed so wholesome all of a sudden.

I said quietly, 'You're not going to tell me anything? I thought all this was for us. To improve our relationship.'

She smiled, 'It will improve our relationship. We're having our horizons expanded, right? We're doing what makes us happy.'

'So you're falling for him?'

She folded her arms defensively. 'I don't know. It's too early to say.'

'But it's a possibility?'

'Is that what you're worried about?'

'No,' I sighed, but didn't sound particularly convincing.

'The whole point of polyamory is, if I have feelings for him, it doesn't affect how I feel about you.'

'I get that.'

'When it comes to who I love, there's no limited supply — '

'Sure, but the whole point of you seeing other guys was for us both to enjoy it.' I felt bad about my complaint — it seemed even to me inherently selfish of me. And yet, the whole reason we had gotten into this was to share the hotness of it all between us.

To my surprise, Juliette gave me a sexy little smirk at that, saying, 'We are both enjoying it.'

'Huh?'

She smiled broadly, and even arched her back to push out her chest, like she was flirting with me. 'You know I've been with him. You can't deny that you like knowing that. Even without details.'

She put her hands on her hips, challenging me to deny it. Man, she looked phenomenal.

I hesitated, my brain short-circuited by her hotness.

She put her hand on my chest and gently but firmly pushed me back against the wall, her other hand curling around the back of my head as she pressed her lips up to mine.

Her kiss was so sweet, so sexy. My entire body responded to her, craving her, loving her, obsessing over her. I kissed her and felt like there was no way I could stop her doing whatever she wanted; there was no way I could keep anything from her. I was powerless in her presence.

She wrapped her arms around me, and I smelled another man on her body, I tasted another man on her lips. My resistance to her evaporated.

'I don't need to tell you exactly what he did to me,' she said, breathless, pulling off my shirt now. 'You know what he did. You love it.'

She pressed her hand to my crotch, and my hardness confirmed that she was one hundred percent correct.

I kissed her. Both her hands pressed at my cock, stroking it through my pants. I pulled off her hoodie, which helpfully zipped up the front. I felt a surge of arousal — but also relief. She still wanted me. She was still into me. She was still into this.

Her eyes were ablaze with excitement, her smile inviting me to take whatever I wanted from her.

My hands moved to her breasts, pushing up her sports bra, groping her with powerful lust. She moaned as my hands cupped her, as my fingers

found her stiff nipples.

She turned her back to me, pushing her ass up against my hard cock as I kissed her neck and fondled her tits, enchanted by the clamminess of her flesh, the scent of sex on her skin, the taste of salt.

'Did you both come back here after your run?' I asked her.

'Uh-huh.'

'And he fucked you again?'

'I can't talk about it,' she insisted, her hands reaching for my cock behind her, as though I had her wrists handcuffed.

I slid one of my hands down her front, over her taut stomach, and down beneath her running shorts and her soaking panties.

My fingers skirted over her hairless mound and found the searing heat of her dripping wet sex.

'He fucked you in your running gear,' I said into her ear.

She whimpered as I thrust my fingers into her, unable to get the words out to declare that she could not tell me anything.

'I know he did,' I insisted. 'I would have.'

She couldn't contain her smile as I touched her there. As I worked her with my fingers, the pungent smell of recent sex wafted up her hot body, giving the game away about what she'd done with Ethan just before I'd arrived.

I kissed her neck, thrilled at how wet she was, while she groped my dick and murmured, 'Mmm... you're so hard... you love it... even if I can't tell you about him...' She was right in her determination that it didn't require her to tell me personal details of what had gone on with Ethan — I knew she'd just spent the night with him, that he had given her a proper fucking, and that the last time had been recently, while she'd still been wearing these damp running clothes.

I could taste him on her, I could breathe in that wicked scent that fed my imagination about what had gone on.

I slipped my fingers in and out of my wife's slippery folds, and I could practically sense that another man's cock had been there. I grabbed hold of her, turned her, pushed her up against the wall to kiss her mouth and I could tell those lips had serviced another man's dick.

She was just thrilling to me.

I sank to my knees, dragged down her lycra running shorts to reveal a simple black thong steeped in her morning sex. Then I kissed my way down her trim abdomen, and tugged down her panties too. She stood, panting, clutching my hair as I sucked on her freshly-fucked pussy. God, I couldn't get enough of her.

My night with Jessie had been sexy as hell, but as much as I adored her, nothing turned me on more than my wife — and nothing turned me on more about my wife than when she'd been gratified by another guy.

I knelt there, gorging myself on her flesh, one hand pumping my cock as she held onto my head like the pommel of a saddle and ground her soaking pussy against my mouth.

She came like that, her juices flooding my mouth, tricking down my chin. But then I was up, my remaining clothes around my ankles, steering my hard cock into her exquisite sex from behind. She was just magnificent. The sight of her pert rear as my stiff shaft sank into her just about stopped my heart.

'Oh yes...' she moaned as I grabbed her hip with one hand and ponytail with the other and shoved my rock-hard cock into her all the way. 'Oh fuck me, my love, fuck me...'

She seemed overjoyed that I wanted her this much, that even though she couldn't share the deets of her nocturnal adventures with her new man, I was still so hungry for her.

In truth, there was something about the fact that she couldn't tell me all about her night with Ethan that spurred me on even more. It was surprising to me — but there was some kind of mystery to Juliette that

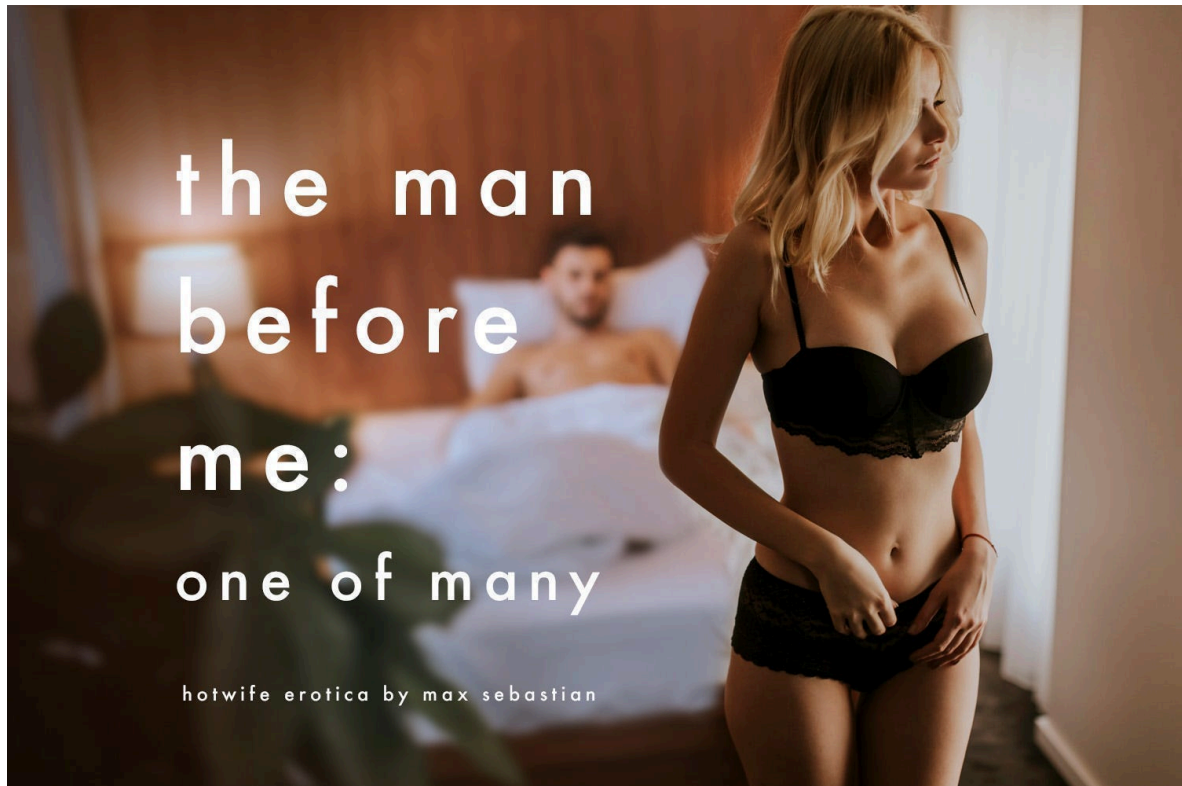
lent her an unexpected additional layer of hotness. There was something wicked about it, something dark and devilish.

Almost like my delicious wife had been cheating on me.

New chapters Wednesdays and Sundays — don't forget to [follow author Max Sebastian](#) so you don't miss an episode! Sign up to [free email alerts here >>](#)

The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.7)

by *Max Sebastian*



Juliette didn't want to explicitly reveal to me the details of the sex she had with Ethan, but she wasn't trying to hide the nature of her relationship with him from me. It wasn't quite like a cheating wife having a covert fling behind her husband's back.

If she was getting ready to go out on a date with him, for example, she liked me to see what she was wearing for him. I might shower with her, help her shave her legs or her pussy, even pick out her underwear.

While she was on her date, she would regularly keep in touch with me via text, letting me know where they were and what they were up to. Even if I was busy myself, I liked to monitor her progress, counting down the hours and minutes until my sweet wife was going to bed with another man.

After her date, she would come back and tell me plenty about what they did together before sleeping together. While she didn't go into what happened behind closed doors, there would be evidence about her person that revealed something about what had gone on between them.

I could smell him on her. I could feel the traces of him lingering on her body. I detected the fact that they used condoms, but I knew he liked to finish on her breasts, and she reveled in having him fire his load all over her.

I could see the redness of her pussy, and could tell from her need for delicate attention that he had serviced her well.

I could interpret her expressions and the glint in her eyes, and even the tone of her voice when she talked about him to know that while Ethan was something of a civilized gent outside the bedroom, between the sheets, he was a beast.

Sure, I wished I could see him with my wife. But it was enough for me to know how things were between them, to know she was getting incredible sex with him, to know how naughty Juliette was with him — even from indirect evidence.

Friday morning.

Juliette was up before me, planning on getting to the office early so that she could leave earlier than usual for a date with the lovely Ethan.

'You're going straight after work?' I asked, lying there in bed watching her dry off after a shower.

'Ethan wants to take me to this Batuqui place in the Village, but he could only get a six o'clock reservation.'

Juliette didn't always get dressed in front of me. In fact, on a normal weekday, one of us tended to dress while the other was showering. But this morning, it seemed like she was purposefully doing it in front of me because she would be seeing Ethan that evening.

She knew it was a little treat for me, given that she couldn't reveal personal details of their intimate activities for privacy reasons.

The white lace g-string she put on, and matching bra, was not the typical kind of thing she wore for a day at the office. The white, thigh-high stockings made my heart race and my manhood thicken up. Boy. She really was going out on a date as soon as work ended.

'Would you be offended if I share details about us with him?' she asked me.

'What kind of details?' I said, trying to sound calm, and not like some raving pervert hoping desperately that if she divulged our secrets to her new boyfriend, he might allow her to reveal some of their sexual secrets in return.

'He's kind of interested to learn more about our journey,' she said, sitting to roll her stockings up her legs.

'Okay... I don't have a problem with that.'

She smiled. 'I'm not promising anything, but if he understands a little more about you and me... I guess he might be open to me sharing a little more with you about him and me.'

Pay attention, double-oh seven. The pronouns got so very complicated when you got involved in polyamory.

'How much do you think he'll want to know?'

'I think I should tell him that you enjoy the fact that I see other guys,' she said.

'That it turns me on?'

She looked at me a moment, and we were both considering the possibility of opening up to someone new about my particular kink. She said, 'I don't have to get too personal about it. But maybe it's right to tell him, you know... you're not squeamish about me sleeping with other people.'

'Do you think he'll get worried about you sharing too much with me?'

'He might do.'

'And how do you feel about that?'

'Nervous. I do like him. I have a lot of fun with him.'

'You have good sex with him?' I smiled, knowing that I was trying to push the boundaries, and she had told me she wasn't telling me that kind of thing.

She smiled, knowing I was just being playful.

I said, 'You'll just have to gauge his reaction. Drop a little info here and there, and see how he reacts. If he's not put off by it, you could open up a little more.'

'And you don't mind if... things come out about you?' she said, standing to put on her knee-length skirt.

'He's not going to blab about it with other people?'

She shook her head. 'I wouldn't think so. He's fairly experienced. He'd respect that kind of sensitive information, even about a Meta.'

I shrugged. 'So then, there's no problem.'

She nodded. 'I guess if he doesn't like the thought of you... thinking about me when I'm with him...'

'If it comes to that, maybe you just need to dial it back a little. Would you tell him about our little thing with Brian and Jessie?'

'Our little thing?' she grinned. 'I guess I can say we party together sometimes. But I'd need to talk to Brian and Jess before revealing details to someone else...'

There seemed to be so much negotiation with polyamory. I could hardly complain. It was only about being fair to everybody involved. But I liked the idea of Juliette opening up more with Ethan.

Once Juliette had put her shirt on, she looked much as she usually did for work — it was just sexy to know she was wearing lingerie underneath, ready for her date.

On that particular Friday, I was in touch with Brian and Jessie to see if one or other of them might want to hang out with me while Juliette was with Ethan.

If I'd been a normal mono guy asking his new date whether she wanted to do something that evening, I would have just contacted her, of course. But it felt wrong not to reach out to Brian as well to see what he was up to — perhaps he already had plans to spend the evening with Jessie. Maybe they would both be tired, or sick or something.

First thing that morning, the initial response was that Jessie would love to do something with me, and Brian would be only too delighted if I did something with his soon-to-be-fiancee.

But then something unexpected happened.

Jessie revealed to us both, within a group text message, that the guy she had a crush on at work had been flirting with her more than usual at the team meeting in their office that morning. And then, shortly after that, he'd dropped her a little email asking if she wanted to get lunch together.

Naturally, both Brian and I were very supportive of her flirting with the guy, Jason, as well as going out for lunch with him.

But it was an odd moment for me. This felt a little different from Juliette seeing another guy. Jessie was like my new girlfriend — we were still fizzing with that new relationship energy, even though we'd been friends for years. I wasn't married to her, I didn't have that formalized relationship with her — and now she was expressing interest in a third guy.

So, while the depraved part of me was turned on by the thought of my new girlfriend being even more wicked with some additional male attention, I felt that innate anxiety of someone in a new relationship who didn't know if it would survive, even though the attraction between Jessie and I was strong.

I guess I hadn't really expected to feel this way about Jessie. I thought what I had with her would just be something fun, some trivial sex with a beautiful blonde on nights when my wife was away with her other partner.

But here we were now, texting between the three of us about how Jessie should respond if Jason started giving her signals that he was interested in something — and it felt almost as though we were talking about her cuckolding both Brian and me.

'Should I tell him I'm seeing you guys as well?' she asked, just before she was due to head out to secretly meet Jason at a venue away from potential office spies. 'Should I tell him I'm poly?'

'How much does he know about your personal life already?' I asked.

'I think people in the office generally know I have a boyfriend,' she said. 'I don't keep Brian a secret, at least.'

Brian said, 'It would probably end up being easier if you just tell the truth.'

I asked her, 'What kind of vibes do you get from him? That he would want something no-strings, or that he would be interested in something long-term?'

Jessie said, 'I know he's divorced, he doesn't seem like he's desperate for something major.'

'He must be in the market for something secret if he's hitting on somebody at work,' Brian said.

Jessie agreed. 'I think we're all pretty aware what the company policy is on relationships within the office. And he doesn't seem like he'd be open to changing jobs right now.'

'He must have asked around about you,' I said. 'He must have got the sense you have a boyfriend.'

'Or else he doesn't care one way or the other,' Brian chipped in.

'I guess I just need to find out more about what he's hoping for,' Jessie said.

It was actually exciting, waiting while knowing that Jessie was out having lunch with a guy with a view to something happening with him.

While it was happening, Brian came over so we could grab lunch together and wait for news.

'She'll tell us when it's finished, right?' I asked him.

'Yeah, she'll tell us.'

'Is it weird that I'm nervous?'

He smiled. 'Not at all. She's your girlfriend, too.'

'I'm not the one about to ask her to marry me.'

His face turned serious when I said that. I was suddenly worried he'd changed his mind about something, something important. He asked me, 'You're still okay with me doing it?'

'Asking her to marry you? Of course!'

He gazed at me solemnly for a moment, as though making sure I was telling the absolute truth. Then he said, 'This is a little complicated, you have to admit. We're not exactly in a normal arrangement, even for poly people.'

'Because we're both into the hotwife thing?'

He nodded. 'You're more than just another boyfriend for her.'

'But you are her primary. And I'm Juliette's.'

'Can there be a 'secondary'?' he joked. Then his expression turned solemn again. He took a side-to-side glance, checking for spies. Then he pulled something out of his inside jacket pocket.

A small jewelry box — the kind you might keep a ring in.

He opened it to reveal a diamond engagement ring.

I caught my breath.

'What do you think?' he said quietly.

I gazed at it a moment — it was an impressive ring; I had to hand it to him. Then I joked, a little too loudly, 'Of course I'll marry you!'

Suddenly, from all around us, a round of applause broke out. Everyone else in the deli was looking at us like we were in a stage production, smiling and, in some cases, even appearing to tear up, just delighted for our special moment.

Frozen to the spot, with his hand holding the ring still thrust out toward me, Brian turned his head to slowly take in the sight of our assembled audience — realizing that to everyone else, it did appear to look clearly as though he had just asked me to marry him and I'd accepted.

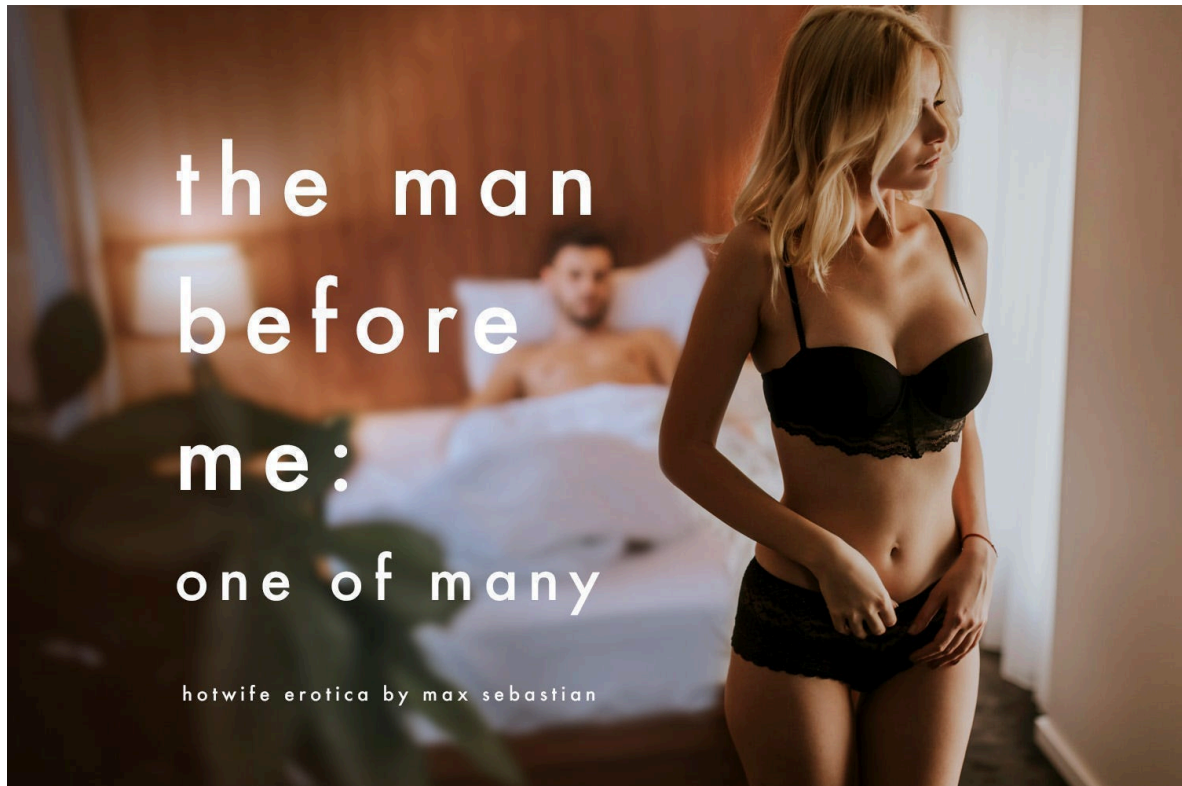
He was blushing like crazy.

Ah well, we were both cackling like hyenas as we fled the scene.

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The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.8)

by *Max Sebastian*



Back in the office, Brian and I waited for news from Juliette, continuing our lunch conversation via text message. In particular, we discussed when Brian was going to pop the question.

Brian wanted to do it when we were all together because he said that we were basically a polycule now, and that getting married would impact me as well. My view was that this was a very personal choice for Jessie and him, so it might be better to do it when it was just the two of them.

'I mean, Juliette's really a part of our polycule, too, if you define it a certain way. But then, you do it when we're all together and it starts to become more of a party.'

'I suppose so, then if Juliette's doing well with Ethan, do I have to do it when everyone's together? Maybe it's better just the two of us.'

I suggested: 'We can throw an engagement party once the deed is done.'

He seemed to like that idea.

Then Jessie appeared in our WhatsApp group, and so the conversation veered into what had happened during her lunch with the hunky Jason.

'We're going to meet for a drink tonight!' she announced, and even though I'd been planning on spending the evening with her since Juliette was going out with Ethan, this seemed like a good development.

It seemed a little crazy that I'd only just started dating Jessie, and already, I was hoping she would cuckold me. I guess that was just how I was wired.

Knowing our previous plan, Jessie asked me if I'd be okay with her seeing Jason that evening, and naturally, I was very supportive, particularly as she promised to see me when she was done with him.

'And then when you're done with me, you'll see Brian?' I asked her, and we joked about this double layer of cuckolding her primary would potentially face.

Anyway. Jessie told us about her lunch with Jason; that the two of them had decided that if anything was going to happen between them, it had to be kept in the utmost secrecy. They were both doing well at their firm — a blue-chip advertising agency on Madison Avenue — and didn't want to trip up on the corporate fraternizing policy.

Jessie said Jason had just been through a difficult divorce and didn't like the idea of getting involved in a serious relationship right now.

'Did you tell him about us?' Brian asked her.

'He knows I have a boyfriend, but he didn't want to know anything beyond that. He said it's not a big deal to him what I get up to when I'm not with him. It's like when you're just dating someone, and you're not exclusive yet.'

'But you didn't say anything about your boyfriend being aware of you seeing Jason?' I asked her.

'He seems to assume I'm going to keep this secret from my boyfriend like it's an affair,' she said. 'I think he's comfortable with that.'

'Probably because it means you'll keep things casual with him,' Brian pointed out. 'Won't get too serious.'

*

It turned out that Jessie had agreed to meet Jason for a drink at 10pm. It seemed late for the start of a date, but Jessie explained that it was part of trying to keep things very separate from work.

I wasn't complaining — it meant I got to hang out with her and Brian and have dinner with them before Jessie had to get ready for her date with Jason.

'Jason wants to pretend we're not even particularly friendly with each other at the office,' Jessie explained over pizza in front of the TV.

'But you just had lunch with him,' Brian said.

'But we left the office separately,' she said. 'It's like we're spies.'

'So you have to pretend that you don't like each other in the office?' I laughed.

Jessie grinned. 'Not that we don't like each other, just like we're normal co-workers, you know. Nothing special.'

'No flirting in the office?' I complained.

'It's safer,' Brian said.

Jessie agreed. 'I really can't afford to lose my job right now.'

After we finished eating, Jessie wanted Brian and I to keep her company while she got ready for her date with Jason. Brian and I were happy to oblige, following her into the bedroom with our current beers to watch her prepare for her night out.

The feeling in the air was not unlike how it was between Juliette and me when I watched her get ready for a date with another guy — except that

there were three of us in this bedroom.

Jessie was just buzzing around, deciding what to wear. She seemed so happy, just fizzing with the prospect of what might happen that night.

After we'd helped her pick out an outfit, she said, 'Is it crazy, I have two gorgeous men here with me already, and I'm getting ready to disappear into the night to meet with someone else?'

Brian stepped toward her and curled an arm around her waist to pull her to him for a tender kiss. 'Not at all,' he said. 'You just happen to be dating two guys who enjoy you being free to see other people as well.'

I stepped behind her as she kissed my friend, stroking her bare arms, leaning down to kiss her shoulder. She moaned as I brushed her golden hair out of the way so that I could gently kiss her neck.

'Mmm... I should get in the shower,' she said, sweeping her hands around Brian's chest.

'You have plenty of time,' he said.

Smiling, she turned her head to claim a kiss on my lips, her hand curling around my neck as our mouths pressed together. Her kiss was so sweet. I could feel her tremble a little, revealing her nerves. I knew she wasn't like this because Brian and I were kissing her — this was first date nerves.

'Will you go back to his place after a drink or two?' I asked her, stroking my cheek against hers as Brian slipped his hands up inside her top to cup her breasts.

'I guess so,' she said. 'I mean, I don't think he has anyone living with him right now, so...'

She kissed Brian's lips, and then turned to kiss mine, as Brian took advantage of the fact that she wasn't wearing a bra. In between kisses for us both, we pulled up her top and removed it over her head. Her nipples were so stiff as we took turns sucking on them or kissing her mouth.

'What're you doing?' Jessie moaned.

'Warming you up for your date,' I murmured into her ear as Brian knelt to place kisses around her bare stomach.

'You're going to make me all horny by the time I go out,' she complained.

'Hopefully,' Brian said, before sucking on her gorgeous tits.

Brian stood to kiss her mouth, his hands moving to fondle her breasts, while I knelt to unfasten the button on her jeans, and tug them down her legs to reveal a pink lacy pair of panties. Well, she'd have to take them off before taking a shower anyway.

She moaned as I gently lodged my hand between her legs and felt the heat of her sex through the thin pink lace. The material became damp as I touched her there.

I tugged down her panties to expose her bare pussy, slipping a finger into her hairless slit to draw out a loud moan from her. She was dripping wet already.

'Are you going to join me in the shower?' Jessie grinned. 'I'm not sure we'll all fit in there.'

Yet, after a few drinks, it seemed like a fun experiment to see if we could all fit in Brian's small shower. To start with, it seemed like we'd have difficulty enough getting into the bathroom together, but we were game, and both Brian and I had had enough drinks to think it was wild trying to get Jessie as horny as possible before she went out to meet her co-worker.

Jessie helped pull off my clothes while Brian got the shower flowing and up to temperature. She was so smiley as she knelt in front of me and took my hard cock in her hands.

'I like knowing I have you two waiting for me tonight, in case things don't go well with Jason,' she said.

'And even if things go well with Jason,' Brian pointed out as Jessie slipped the tip of my manhood into her mouth.

We weren't in any kind of rush — there was still plenty of time before Jessie had to meet Jason at 10pm. For a while, Brian kept back and just watched Jessie sucking on my cock. Then we all transferred to the shower to see if we could squeeze in together. It was intimate, that was for sure. There was just about room for three people to stand up, so long as we were pressed together, Jessie in the middle of the sandwich.

We were all giggles and chuckles as Brian and I did our best to soap up our sexy blonde, while her hands worked our stiff cocks. Carefully, Jessie was able to kneel so she could suck on my dick some more, while Brian washed her hair.

It seemed that the optimum arrangement for the space was to have one person kneeling while the other two stood over them. Either Jessie kneeling to take one or other of us in her mouth, or else one of us down there between her thighs, eagerly lapping at her juicy pussy.

It was a complete riot, but while Jessie was begging us to fuck her, both Brian and I declined the opportunity.

'You should save yourself for your hot date,' Brian pointed out.

She pouted at that, though she saw the point.

'Plenty of time for all that when you're done with him,' I reassured her.

The cruel part of our treatment was that we did not allow her to reach orgasm throughout the entire process. She was practically ready to hump a pillow by the time we got out of the shower, and it was time for her to get dressed.

Perhaps her state of abject horniness explained why she allowed Brian and me to pick out the most scandalous lingerie for her to wear on her date — a tiny black partly-sheer g-string, stockings, and garter belt with a matching sheer bra.

'What if I put all this on, and he doesn't sleep with me?' she asked as we connected up her garters to her stocking tops. 'I mean, it is kind of our first date.'

'You still get to sleep with us after,' I reminded her, making her smile.

'Lunch was your first date,' Brian said. 'And anyway, who plans on meeting a date at 10pm if they're not intending on having sex?'

The lacy black dress she put on over the top of her saucy underwear also seemed to underline the sense that she was expecting to have sex that night — it had a hint of high-class call-girl about it. Again, I got the feeling that Jessie wouldn't have agreed to wear it if she hadn't been wound up by our treatment of her in the shower.

With a bit of makeup and a spritz of perfume, our girl looked absolutely stunning by the time the Uber arrived to take her to her duly appointed meeting place.

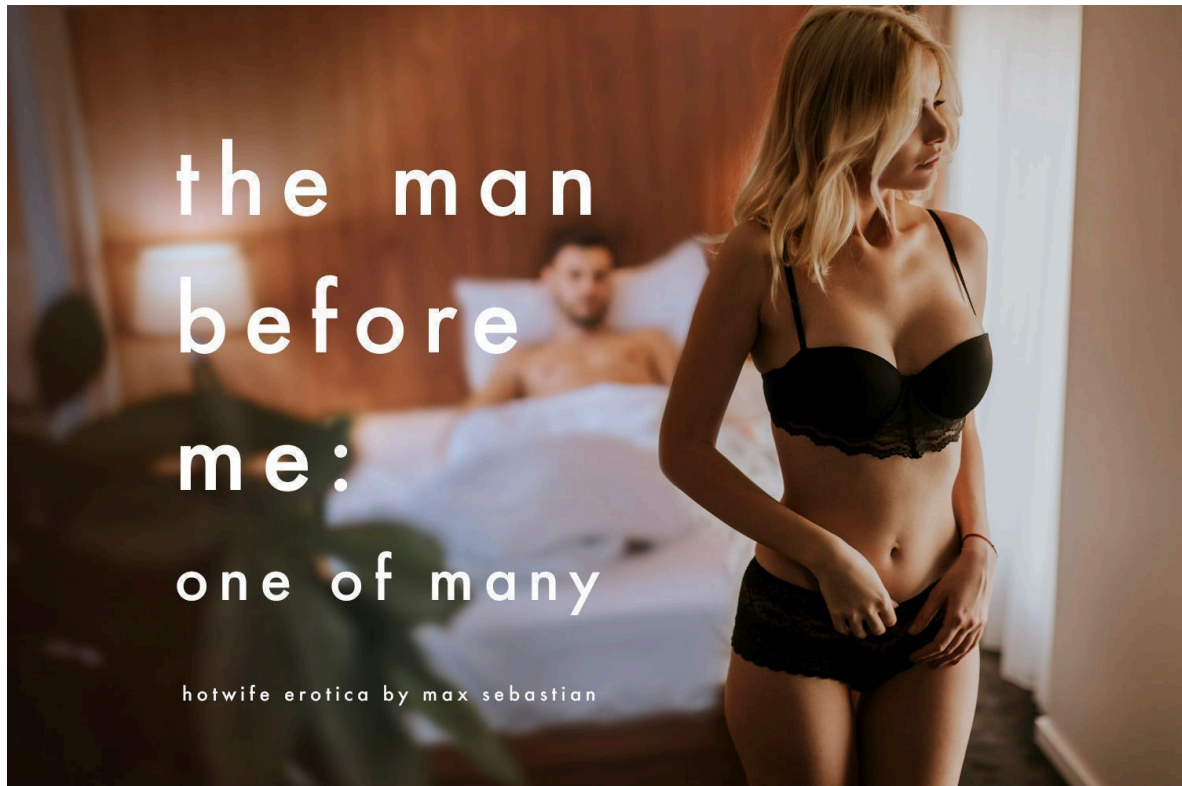
I was surprised at how excited I felt, standing at the door and watching her disappear down the hallway toward the elevators. Wasn't I supposed to be the boyfriend? And yet, I viewed Jessie as mine now, mine to be shared.

And then, she was gone, and I had to wait while both of my sweet blondes slept with other men.

New chapters are released each week, usually Wednesdays — don't forget to [follow author Max Sebastian](#) so you don't miss an episode! Sign up to [free email alerts here >>](#)

The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.9)

by *Max Sebastian*



Here she was, at last.

Brian had already gone to bed, but I stayed up until Jessie came home from her date, texting me as she left her co-worker's apartment and got safely into an Uber for the ride home.

I greeted her at the front door, taking her in my arms, tasting her lips.

I could tell before she even said a word that she'd done it, that she'd crossed that next boundary. I could tell from her flushed cheeks, her smeared makeup. The victorious, satisfied smile that spread across her face. The dampness of her hair.

The smell of man on her as I kissed her mouth.

'I'm sorry it's so late,' she whispered.

'It's okay,' I reassured her, helping her take off her jacket and hang it up. 'I thought you might end up staying the night.'

'I didn't think you'd still be awake,' she said.

'We thought one of us should be.'

She smiled. I stared at her for a moment, taking in the sight of her. As attractive as she'd been before, she was doubly so now. At least.

What was it with me and freshly fucked women?

'It happened, then?' I asked her, pulling her to me, kissing her mouth, tasting that strange flavor of another man on her. Fresh cock.

She nodded.

'And how was it?'

She paused as though not quite sure how to put it into words. Then she said, 'It was unbelievable.'

'Big dick?'

She tilted her head as though she hadn't even thought about that. 'Big enough,' she said.

I slipped the straps of her lacy black dress off her shoulders and allowed the garment to fall. She was still wearing her elegant, black sheer lingerie.

'How did it feel?' I asked her. 'Being with him?'

'Amazing, incredible, unbelievable,' she said, beaming as I held her at arm's length to look her over, to examine her after bedding another man.

'He was good in bed, then?'

'He was good, yeah.'

I laughed. 'You make him sound kinda three-out-of-five.'

She grinned, 'The five-out-of-five is knowing you guys are waiting for me when I'm done with him. How much it gets you going that I just fucked him.'

'Come on, Brian wants to be woken up when you're back.'

She lay beside him, put her hand on his elbow, amused that he was still asleep. He was still out as she curled a hand around his head and leaned in to kiss his lips.

He smiled, opening his eyes. 'It happened?'

'Uh-huh,' she beamed, seeing him so happy.

I watched her stroke his arm, kissing him again. Jessie murmuring to him, telling him about her adventure, about how naughty she'd been, that she'd sucked on the guy's cock for ages, that he'd fucked her hard.

They were sweet together, I was glad they were primary in this little arrangement of ours. They were such good people, they deserved their love for each other. But then Brian asked about me, wondering if she'd fucked me since returning from Jason, and she was turning to look for me.

They both seemed happy as I joined them, Jessie twisting as she lay beside Brian so that she could kiss me as I lay beside her.

Man, she was so sexy lying there in only her thigh-high stockings. Her kiss was so sweet, and yet there was something so spicy about being with her while Brian lay there, too. It was the mainstream norm of coupledness disrupted by the presence of three in a bed.

For a while, we were just making out — Brian and I taking turns kissing her mouth, her neck, her bare breasts. Hands running over her body, taking in the feel of her freshly-fucked form — the subtle traces of her previous workout, the signs of exercise, and the lingering traces of the man who had fucked her.

She moaned as I pressed my hard cock against her butt, her hand reaching behind to stroke the bulge in my underwear.

'Was he good?' Brian asked at one point.

Jessie giggled. 'He was fine.'

'Is that all?'

'That's what I said,' I chuckled.

'It felt good,' she said. 'But you know the hottest part was knowing you guys were waiting for me at home.'

She kissed Brian, and her hand grabbed my boxer shorts, tugging on them to free my erection. I helped her expose it, and her hand was already taking hold of my shaft as I removed my remaining article of clothing.

'You did want him, though,' Brian said.

'Uh-huh,' she said, stroking my cock. 'But the thrill was in knowing I could have him and then come back to you. It was hot, but then I started thinking about you guys...'

'Would you want to see him again?'

I kissed her shoulders, and my hand reached between her thighs, feeling how wet she was there, a little shiver of exhilaration from knowing her date had been there before, fucking her just minutes before.

'Sure,' she said, running her hands down Brian's chest, 'But you know, the best part is you guys sending me out to get fucked... and then when I get to come back...'

As she made out with Brian, Jessie reached behind her, her fingers finding my hard cock, guiding it to her pussy. I didn't need much encouragement. She moaned as my tip slid inside her, and pulled back from her kiss to groan as I filled her, hanging on tight to my friend.

'Does that feel good, my love?' I heard Brian murmur to her as he kissed her just below the ear.

She sighed, 'Oh yes...'

Brian and I sandwiched her between us as I fucked her slowly from behind, Jessie wrapping her arms around her soon-to-be fiancée as I thrust into her. It felt so good.

After a while, she moved down on Brian, her hand finding his hard cock, stroking him as I continued to fuck her. I moved to accommodate her change of position so she could take him in her mouth, Brian lying there on his back with his eyes closed.

God, Jessie was so sexy, and we were so into her, just eating her up. I felt so close to them — Brian and I could take what we wanted from her and just coordinate around her, appreciating her beauty, worshipping her body, reveling in her sex with another man — and with each other.

I lay beside her and continued fucking her, and lifted her leg so that Brian could move down to suck on her clit while I thrust into her. Then, after a while, she was on her back, and I made way for him to slide into her.

I watched him fuck her for a while, not needing to rush, and then eventually rejoined, presenting my cock to her mouth as he pounded her. Then shortly after that, she was on top of me, riding me while Brian watched us, lying back as she reached out to pump his cock.

We were a blur, the three of us. Slowly writhing on the bed, changing positions, taking turns to be inside her, to fuck her mouth, or to press our lips to her soaking wet pussy and slide a tongue inside her.

When we hit our first orgasm, Jessie was on all fours, with me pounding into her from the rear, each thrust pushing her onto Brian's dick as we properly spit-roasted her. Despite her mouth being full, the rising pitch of her moans and her shivering body announced her approaching climax, and as she finally wailed and shuddered with two cocks stuffed inside her, we both released our loads at either end.

She had such a huge smile on her pretty face as we finally disengaged and lay together on the bed, panting.

In the morning, I showered at Brian and Jessie's place before heading back to find out how Juliette's night had gone with Ethan. I guess it felt a little more civilized to me, cleaning up before returning to my sweet

wife. But I had a toothbrush stationed at Brian and Jessie's place now. That made me feel like things were changing.

It was still relatively early as I took the subway back to the Upper East Side, so I texted Juliette to find out whether it was safe for me to return to her.

She told me it was, that I should come straight on up.

To my surprise, Ethan was still there when I arrived. The two of them were having breakfast together — looking so much like they were the married couple. Ethan was dressed already, while Juliette sat at the table wearing a bathrobe.

'Hey, how's it going?'

'Pretty good. You guys have fun last night?'

'Oh, yeah, it was great.'

I sat and had breakfast with them — it was like we were all roommates. Ethan was perfectly friendly; there wasn't an ounce of hostility between us, not that I was expecting any. I liked him. I liked that he was fucking my wife. It was strangely fascinating to sit there and chat with him, knowing he'd just spent the night with Juliette.

Then, as he was heading out, he said, 'Hey, we should get a drink together sometime, maybe this week?'

Jeez, it was like he was asking me out. However, I was curious to get to know him better. To talk to the man who had been fucking my wife.

For some reason, the idea reminded me of my chat with Cory way back when during Juliette's high school reunion.

'Uh... sure. That would be great. How about Wednesday?'

'Perfect. I'll text you, buddy.'

And then he was gone, and Juliette was looking at me with a delighted smirk sprawled across her face.

'Sounds like you have a date,' she joked.

'It does, doesn't it?' I laughed.

We got up to clear up our breakfast things, and she said, 'You'll like him, he's a nice guy.'

'Yeah, seems like,' I agreed while filling the dishwasher.

'I told you he's interested in how we got into this.'

'I guess we are into it now.'

'I haven't said much about... you know. Where you're coming from.'

I nodded. 'And would you have a problem with me talking about it if he wants to know more?'

She shrugged. 'I'm an open book with you guys. Whatever Ethan's comfortable talking about is good with me.'

'An open book,' I said, standing in front of her, peeling off her bathrobe to reveal a little black tank top and black lace panties beneath. 'I like that.'

She smiled, loving my attention, my desire.

'What have you said to him about me?' I asked her, taking her in my arms, kissing her, breathing in that scent of another man on her, that smell of sex. They must have had sex that morning, though that wasn't a huge surprise. Ethan seemed to have showered, but Juliette hadn't.

She smiled. 'I told him you enjoy knowing that I sleep with other guys.'

'Does that kind of thing freak him out?'

She shook her head. 'I think... he just doesn't really understand where you're coming from.'

I took hold of her, my arms tensing up as I lifted her onto the kitchen counter. She let out a little squeal as I manhandled her, but then she was

perched there on the counter, legs apart, offering me a seductive smile, knowing I was craving her.

'He doesn't understand a guy who likes that his wife sleeps with other people?' I probed.

She reached out with a foot, pressing it against my crotch, feeling my hardness there. It made her giggle. 'He doesn't really think about me being with you or anybody else. He just kind of shuts it out, it's not an issue to him.'

'Because he doesn't like to think about it?'

I crouched, lowering my head down between her splayed thighs, inhaling the pungent aroma from her pussy, covered only by a thin band of black lace.

'He just doesn't think about it,' she said. 'He dates women and sometimes commits to them, but if they're not with him at the time, he doesn't particularly dwell on it. Or where they've been.'

I stroked a hand down over the front of her panties, feeling the heat of her body through the thin material, the squishiness of her pussy, the damp lace covering her slit.

What can I say? I loved her scent; I loved the evidence of her tryst with another man.

'I know where you've been,' I said, touching my nose and my lips to her panties, filling my lungs with her spice.

'I know you do,' she moaned.

'So right now, what is he thinking I'm doing with you?'

She tilted her head. 'He's probably not thinking about you at all. Or me. He's moved on to the next thing.'

'But he assumes, what, that I'm eating breakfast now, and you're going to hop in the shower, and then we'll just be like a normal couple?'

I tugged aside her panties, revealing the full glory of her freshly-fucked pussy.

She gasped as I pressed my mouth to her slit, as I sucked on her lips. 'You are eating breakfast...' she grinned.

'I've never eaten it straight off the counter before...' I joked. She paused to take off her panties, but then I was giving her a full tongue bath there on the counter, relishing the evidence of her night's sexual encounter.

Even if Ethan never wanted me to discuss sexual details with her, I was still going to enjoy the fact that my sweet wife was fucking him.

I could fill in the details with my imagination, and it was still hot because I knew she was definitely fucking him.

'So why does he want to meet up on Wednesday?' I asked her as she hopped back down onto the floor and turned to bend over the counter so that I could slide my hard cock into her well-fucked pussy from behind.

'I told you, he's interested in you. Because you come at this from such a different angle.'

'You're not worried... I'll talk to him... and put him off you?' I grinned.

She groaned as I filled her, as I began thrusting into her. 'I... don't think... you'll put him off...' she said, panting as the second man to fuck her that morning got up to speed, grasping her gorgeous ass, feeling her pussy tight around my cock after it had so recently enveloped someone else's.

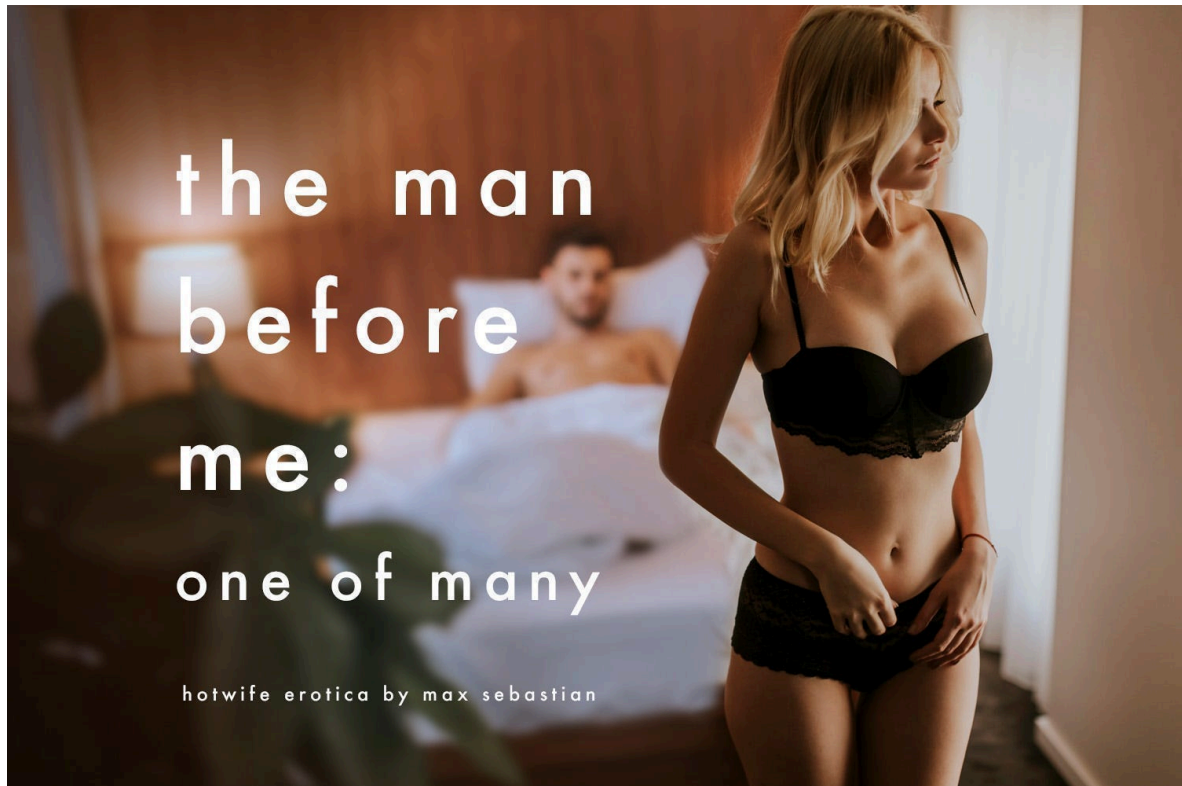
God, it felt good. Even if she and Ethan were using condoms, she was so wet and already primed for an easy orgasm.

Polyamory felt fantastic.

New chapters are released each week, usually Wednesdays — don't forget to [follow author Max Sebastian](#) so you don't miss an episode! Sign up to [free email alerts here >>](#)

The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.10)

by *Max Sebastian*



Ethan was in finance, though despite doing very well for himself so far, he was somewhat down about it. He was in the investment end of the industry and under the impression that his job was under pressure from being replaced by AI.

But we weren't here to talk about work.

After a suitable amount of small talk and getting to know each other, along with an appropriate amount of alcohol, we felt ready to table the main subject du jour.

'Juliette says you like knowing she's with other guys?'

'Uh... yeah, that's right.'

The funny thing was, everything about Ethan — his good looks, his job, his talking voice — made me think he would be the kind of alpha brute who would look down on a guy like me, make fun of my particular kink, and seek to humiliate me in order to build up his own sense of worth. But Ethan wasn't like that. He was surprisingly nice.

'I don't really think about it. Never really did, to be honest. I would date somebody... and if they were dating other people, too, then fine. It wasn't an issue.'

'You started out monogamous?' I asked him.

'I suppose I was in college,' he said. 'I dated girls, and after a few dates it was kind of assumed we were exclusive, right? But here in New York, you're dating people and it's kind of assumed you're not exclusive until you've been with someone a while and you're ready to settle down with them. But it turned out I liked being in that not exclusive stage.'

'So you became poly?'

He shrugged. 'I happened to be dating someone who was poly. I really liked her. But what she said about relationships, how she looked at it — kind of clicked with how I saw myself.'

'So, did it change you? Seeing how she saw things?'

'I guess it opened my eyes to going further with someone, you know? Previously, I dated people until we felt obligated to go exclusive or split up. Afterward, I started dating people who didn't need to be exclusive even after we had feelings for each other — because they identified as poly.'

'But it was never on your mind that sometimes they would be with other guys?' I asked. 'To think about what was happening while they were with somebody else?'

He took a sip of his beer. We were in The Dead Rabbit, a cozy bar near Battery Park.

'I mean, I knew it was happening, obviously. I just didn't really think about it. It was like if she was having a night out with the girls or dinner

with her parents or something.'

'You didn't get jealous when she spent the night with someone else...?'

'Just wasn't an issue. I mean, I know what happens when she spends the night with a Meta.'

'But it doesn't make you feel anything?'

'It's just sex, right? It's like she's going to the gym or something. But it sounds like you really dwell on it. You get jealous?' he asked.

'It's not really jealous,' I said, feeling the alcohol warm in my bloodstream, actually helping me to open up to him. 'I think it may be related to jealousy, but... it's kind of exciting. I don't really worry I'll lose her, although you never quite let go of that...'

'You're worried she'll leave you?'

'Well... it's just instinctive, I think. But in a funny way that makes the thrill ride feel more exciting. That she's going off to do naughty things with another guy.'

'So it does turn you on that she's sleeping with someone else?'

I felt myself blushing furiously. Talking about such intimate details with a guy I hardly knew. But this was a guy who was sleeping with my wife. We shared a strange connection.

'Yeah, it's a turn-on,' I said after a big gulp of pilsner. 'I think of her stripping off for someone else, doing the deed. It makes me want her more. It makes her seem that much more sexy.'

He was peering at me, scrutinizing me — and yet he wasn't horrified; he wasn't being judgmental. 'Right now, if Juliette — or Brooke — was flirting with another guy at whatever bar they're in. If one of them ended up taking the guy home... it just wouldn't be an issue to me.'

While I was having a drink after work with Ethan, Juliette was currently hanging out with Brooke at some bar or other in the Village.

'But tonight, if you actually stopped and thought about Brooke — or Juliette — being with that guy. Or whoever. It wouldn't make you feel anything?' I asked him.

'I don't think so,' he said, then chuckled. 'I must look like some kind of sociopath to you.'

I laughed. 'Probably helps in the finance sector.'

He nodded with a broad smile. 'But I don't need to feel jealous or anything like that,' he said. 'We're polyamorous. If she really likes someone else, that's fine. She doesn't have to leave me for him. She can have both of us.'

'But you don't think about her... you know... having fun...'

'Well, obviously, I'm happy to think she's having fun, whatever she's doing,' he said. 'But it doesn't really... get me going so much. At least, I don't think it does.'

'Do you think if you were watching Juliette having sex with someone else, you would feel something? I mean... disgusted, or excited, or envious of the guy with her, or something else?'

'I never really thought of it like that. I guess... I would appreciate how beautiful she is. I might feel envious if she was having a good time. But you — have you watched her with other guys?'

I sipped my beer, nodded, feeling myself flushing again. 'I have seen her. That first time... we were all pretty drunk. She brought her ex back to our room. It ended up, she slept with him and I was there too.'

'Man,' he said, and his surprise seemed unexpected to me. I think because he was polyamorous, he was accustomed to dating multiple women concurrently. And yet, watching someone else have sex wasn't necessarily a normal thing for poly people.

'Since then... there have been a few occasions,' I said. I felt oddly guilty about talking about me and Juliette fooling around with Jessie and Brian. You really did have to be ethical about disclosing other people's personal

information to a Meta, even if he was sleeping with your wife at the time.

'I really don't know how I'd feel watching,' Ethan said, sipping his beer. It seemed like an odd revelation for someone like him to have.

He said, 'I mean, I watch porn, sometimes. I guess I should find it sexy. Obviously, I find Juliette attractive...'

I said, 'You know, guys like me... everyone's different, how they come at this. Some guys have to watch, some guys prefer not to be there at all, and just want to know details later. Some guys get off on feeling humiliated by their partner sleeping with other people...'

'You like to be humiliated?' he furrowed his brow.

'Oh no, not me. That's not my bag, baby. All I'm saying... some guys are like that. Some want their partners to cheat on them. To feel that burn...'

'I guess it's like BDSM, huh?' he said. 'Some people get off on pain.'

'Maybe,' I nodded. 'I prefer to avoid pain, though. I just find it sexy that my wife happens to like sex with other people.'

He asked, 'Do you two talk about... you know... me sleeping with her?'

I shook my head. He seemed surprised. 'She's pretty strict about revealing what you two get up to. I mean, fair enough. You haven't given her permission...'

'Oh, I don't care what she tells you,' he said. 'You know... she married you. You're not supposed to keep secrets from your spouse, huh?'

I felt a little tickle of excitement inside at that.

He said, 'But you were okay with her spending the night with me, even though she wouldn't tell you any of the details?'

I blushed again. I felt the heat in my cheeks. Man, the blushing was more embarrassing than what I was blushing about.

'I knew she'd been with you. That was enough to make it exciting for me,' I said.

He nodded. 'I guess it's some kind of voyeuristic thing? I get that. But you have to use your imagination to fill in the gaps.'

'Something like that.'

'If I think of Brook... I'm just happy she's spending some time with someone else, she doesn't need me all the time, I can spend a little time with Juliette, or whoever, and see Brook later.'

I smiled. 'It's definitely only a subset of people who think like me. But if you're out at, I don't know, a party, and Brook's with one of her Metas, and they're acting like a couple... maybe they kiss or something. You ever see that?'

'I guess, occasionally,' he said. 'I mean... I don't really dwell on it much. It's just like one of my buddies is making out with a girl. I don't particularly need to see it, right? It's just a PDA. Get a room, guys.'

He chuckled.

I drained my glass. 'The question is, if we were at a party, and you were getting amorous with Juliette, how would you feel if you noticed I could see it happening.'

He tilted his head, pondered the matter for a moment. 'And you'd be enjoying it,' he said, gently nodding, mulling it over.

Cue the blush response. If Harrison Ford wanted to test me as a possible replicant, I would pass with flying colors.

Then he said, 'I don't know... I guess I'd have to see it.'

Returning home at the end of the evening, I was ready to report that I liked Ethan. That we had got on and cleared the air and all that kind of thing.

I had truly opened up to him about my thing for sharing Juliette and was surprised to find that it had hardly fazed Ethan at all.

At the end of the day, his philosophy was that everyone was different — and every polyamorous person had a different angle on relationships, romance, and sex. Somehow, it made me feel better about myself. It gave me the confidence to see that I wasn't doing anything wrong, I wasn't breaking any law. Juliette and I were simply doing what felt right to us.

However, returning home, I would have to wait to report back to Juliette on my conversations with Ethan.

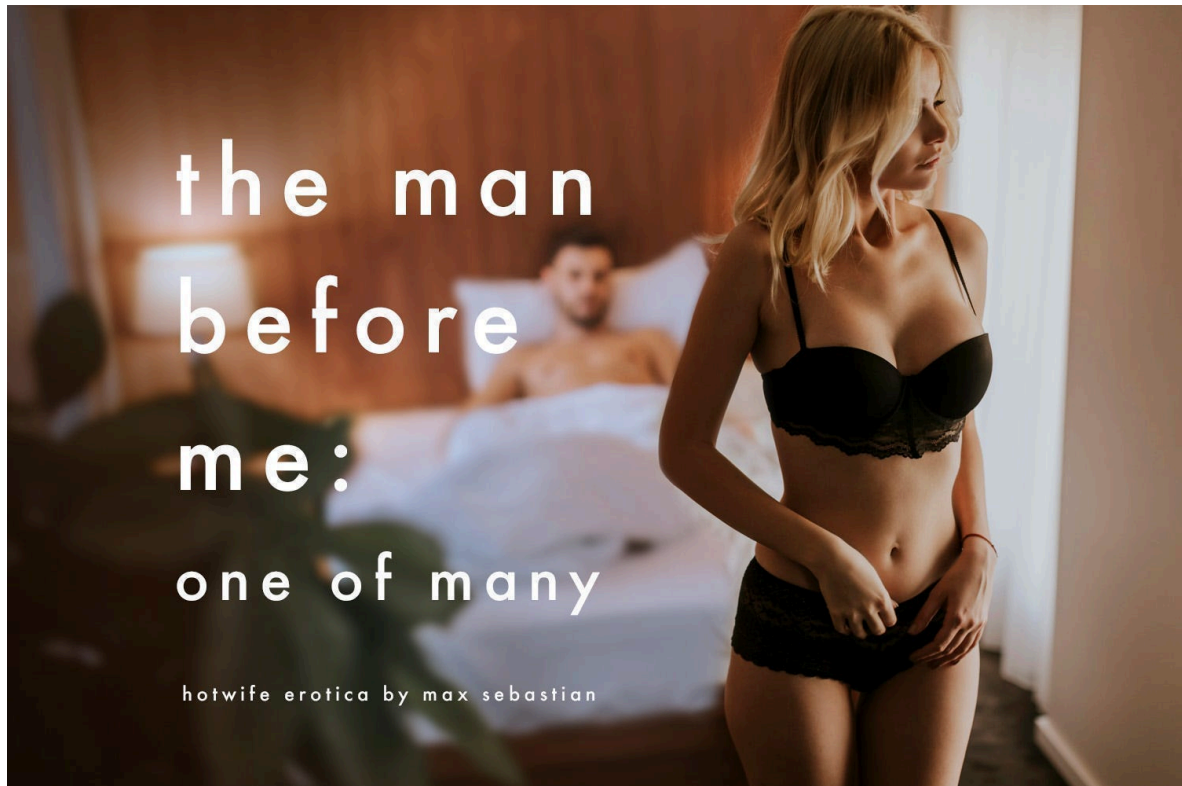
My sweet wife was somewhat absorbed with the news that during a very romantic evening together, one-on-one, my best friend had finally popped the question to her best friend.

Brian and Jessie were getting married.

New chapters are released each week, usually Wednesdays — don't forget to [follow author Max Sebastian](#) so you don't miss an episode! Sign up to [free email alerts here >>](#)

The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.11)

by *Max Sebastian*



We threw a big engagement party for them, of course. It was at their apartment, since Brian and Jessie's place was bigger than ours, but Juliette and I organized everything, and played host, so that the happy couple could just mingle and network and celebrate their upcoming nuptials.

It was a terrific party, naturally.

For Juliette and me, it was all go to start with — making sure everything was ready, welcoming the guests, and checking everyone had everything they wanted. Brian and Jessie were in their element, hobnobbing with family and friends. Unaccustomed but delighted at everything being about them.

Everything started in the early afternoon, mostly with family members and old friends who now had kids. It was mimosas and fruit punch, juice

and nibbles. Polite conversation.

In moments when I could relax and settle a little, and chat to a few people, I caught some interesting glints in some of the family members' eyes. It took me a few moments to work it out.

They knew I was fucking her too.

It wasn't everybody. But Brian and Jessie had definitely informed some of their family members that they were polyamorous. And some of them even knew that I was Jessie's boyfriend. It was all very polite, of course. People didn't talk about other people's sex lives out in the open.

But they knew, or at least some of them.

And after a few mimosas here and there, there were even a few polite questions. So you're also dating Jessie, I understand? How do you feel about all this engagement stuff?

I answered their questions as politely as they were asked. Sometimes Brian was with me as we discussed it. We talked openly about sharing Jessie, even if we didn't get into the nitty-gritty about actually sleeping with her.

Sometimes Jessie would be with us, beaming from ear to ear as she held hands with Brian, occasionally giving him a little kiss to show everybody present how much she loved him. And when we were talking about the whole poly thing, she would take a moment to hold my hand, or flash me a big, affectionate smile, to confirm and even revel in the fact that we had feelings for each other as well.

It felt so crazy.

I didn't want to get in the way, of course. I didn't want to steal any of their limelight — this was their engagement party, this was all about them. So I had to be a little cautious. But there was something unexpectedly thrilling about people knowing.

Those little glints in their eyes. The unasked questions held back by their courtesy that you just knew were front-and-center in their minds.

How does it work, both of you dating her? Do you guys ever have threesomes?

You could tell some of them knew and didn't want to think about it. That was fine, we weren't going to flaunt it around them. You could tell others knew and thought it was perfectly fine — but they didn't really want to dwell on it.

Others, though, you could tell knew about the poly thing and were secretly — or not so secretly — fascinated by it.

Every time I caught a look from someone I knew was curious about the actual sex of it all, I got a little flicker of excitement deep inside. I'm not sure why it was such an odd thrill for this to be out there, to be public among these people. But it was undeniable.

It was about two hours into the party, when Brian and Jessie's family members were beginning to leave, to be replaced by college friends and workmates and those more likely to opt for beer and wine and proper liquor, that I first found a quiet moment to talk to Brian, just the two of us.

And I couldn't help but share how I was feeling about everything.

'Isn't it weird... people know about the poly thing?' I asked him, voice low.

His face instantly sparked as he recognized what I was feeling.

'Every time anyone mentions it, it gets me buzzing,' he said quietly, his eyes aflame. 'It's pretty bizarre. I'm talking to my Aunt Mabel and you know she's secretly thinking about how many times each week Jessie gets to sleep with me, and how many times each week she gets to sleep with you — or whoever.'

'I'm surprised how many people are okay with it,' I grinned.

'How many people are envious,' Brian chuckled.

I offered up a theory about why it felt strangely exciting: 'I guess it's just publicly acknowledging that it's happening, and it makes us think about

other guys being with our other half.'

Brian nodded. 'There are people who might think it's about being publicly humiliated — I mean, there are lots of guys into cuckolding who like that kind of thing. But that's never been me.'

'Me neither.'

'But it's something. I'm guessing it's just the public acknowledgement somehow underlines it all, emphasizes what's going on. Somehow forces you to go with it. And that's exciting.'

As the party emptied of most of the family members, and filled up with friends, there were also more and more mutual friends of Jessie and Juliette's who wanted to know everything about my relationship with both of them.

The alcohol was flowing, and now Jessie and Brian and Juliette and I were feeling more open about public displays of affection to somehow prove we really were embracing this alternative to monogamy.

So here was Brian and I holding onto Jessie, making out with her, celebrating our polycule.

And then here was Evan, arriving a little later in the evening along with his girlfriend Brooke and her boyfriend Zach.

Evan gave me a warm handshake and even a friendly hug as he arrived. After our night out together, it felt like the ice had well and truly thawed between us. He was happy to chat to me as though I were an old buddy, not just someone he'd practically just met.

I thought he might play things carefully, since all our friends were there, and also Brooke and Zach. But Evan gravitated to Juliette's side and didn't seem shy about giving her some fairly full-on PDAs.

One time, I saw him turn his head and seem to purposefully lock eyes with me before pulling Juliette in for a full clinch.

Then there was the time I walked into the kitchen to find him with her, the two of them making out. Though they broke up the moment they

heard my footsteps, as soon as Evan saw it was me, he went back to making out with her right in front of me.

I wasn't stupid. I knew what he was doing. Testing me. Exploring this strange quirk of mine.

Trying to determine whether he could truly freak me out by public displays with Juliette like this.

Well, I wasn't freaked out. I was utterly hooked. I stood there and gaped — or, when other people were around, pretended I wasn't watching.

And they didn't just keep their distance, either. Juliette would come hang out with me, and then Evan would join her, and they would act like the couple in front of me, as though I were merely Juliette's friend. Evan putting his arm around her, cuddling up to her, talking about things they'd done together.

It was so obvious that Evan was purposefully breaching the boundaries he'd previously imposed around his relationship with Juliette — because he'd been so careful up to that point. Up to the point at which we'd had our little night out together, and I'd explained how much it thrilled me to know Juliette was with another man.

It wasn't done subtly, either — and so our friends saw, and commented on our new polyamorous situation, remarking on how happy Juliette seemed to be, how wonderful it was that she got to date other people while married to such a supportive husband, and so on.

There was that strange mix of fascination and envy among our friends that only seemed to heighten the excitement I felt about sharing my wife with this handsome guy in our midst.

Juliette didn't only spend the party in my company or Evan's company, however. As with Jessie, she was happily working the room, and that included plenty of flirting with guys she wasn't currently dating. I enjoyed that part, too, of course.

Some of them I already knew she'd dated back in college, before I'd come along. Some of them were guys she'd met more recently. All of them were aware she was now officially poly, and therefore open to

dating new people if the desire took her. I could tell that they saw her differently now. The careful barriers they'd always put up between themselves and Juliette to prevent anyone from thinking they were being flirtatious with a married woman were now gone. Many of them seemed as excited to flirt with her as I was to watch them doing it.

I was hanging out with Brian, the two of us watching our other halves happily batting their eyelids at other men, when Evan joined us unexpectedly.

'I guess I'm not like you guys, after all,' he said, clutching a beer, glancing over toward Juliette as she chatted with a few of her former college buddies.

He sounded almost mournful, confiding in us, 'I've been watching her making eyes at other guys and... well...'

He shrugged.

Brian asked him, 'Does it bother you? Seeing her with them?'

He didn't need time to ponder that one. 'Not at all. I don't have a problem with it. But I don't get... you know... excited about it. Not like you guys do.'

He seemed genuinely disappointed, as though he'd been hoping to add this extra aspect of dating a polyamorous woman.

'It's not for everyone,' I said, consoling him.

'I've seen how you guys watch them,' he said. 'I mean... you're subtle about it, sure, but it's so clear to me, now I know, how it affects you.'

'You don't have a problem with us?' I said, suddenly concerned that his enlightenment might now spoil his interest in Juliette.

But he offered a friendly smile and a slight shake of his head. 'No,' he said, and chuckled, 'Weirdly, I kind of like it. That you're so into me dating Juliette. And even, you know... sleeping with her.'

There was that touch of awkwardness there — well, this was guys talking about each other fucking the same woman. But the real friction

between us, if it had been there, was no longer present.

Ethan grinned, and then glanced across the room at someone else — Brooke. He said furtively, 'And you know, when I was trying it out... getting a little amorous with our Juliette in public... you'd never guess who else was interested.'

Brian and I stupidly followed Ethan's gaze over to his other girlfriend, totally failing to be in any way subtle, or hide the fact that we were all now talking about Brooke.

She noticed, and blushed, but smiled back at us, apparently enjoying the possibility that we were discussing her.

'Brooke?' I said.

Ethan said, 'She's been watching me with Juliette tonight as well. And every time I get close to her, Brooke gets that same look in her eyes that you guys do.'

'Seriously?' Brian grinned.

'Can women have this same thing you guys have?' Ethan asked.

I shrugged. 'I've heard of it. I mean... why not?'

Brian said, 'There's a name for it. For them. Cuckqueans. Don't ask me why. I've never really looked into it.'

Ethan sipped his drink and then told us, 'So when I go back to Brooke and start talking to her, she's so blatantly thirsty. I mean, she's looking at me like I spiked her drink with some kind of love potion or something.'

I glanced at Brian, who was as amused as I was by the idea that Brooke was one of us.

Ethan said quietly, 'Look, I'll show you.'

Then he broke away from us to quietly join Juliette again, sidling up beside her and engaging in whatever conversation was happening with her college friends. I admired how smoothly and skillfully he could do it.

I'd never been all that great at the whole mingling thing, but Ethan looked like an absolute pro.

After a few moments, Brian and I watched him sling an arm around Juliette — it was gently possessive, emphasizing the two of them as a couple. It made my heart flutter, of course. But after a moment, I remembered that Ethan wasn't testing me at this particular moment.

I cast a clandestine glance toward Brooke, and sure enough, she was also watching Ethan closely. And you could tell she was having feelings about him getting close to another woman.

'She's like us,' Brian said quietly. 'Isn't she?'

It was subtle, but it was unmistakable. She wanted Ethan badly — but it wasn't from jealousy. She wasn't bitter about her boyfriend giving someone else attention, there wasn't an ounce of anger in her bearing.

'She wants him to be with her,' I said. 'You can tell.'

I'd only ever met one person like me — Brian. But it was surprising how self-affirming it was to recognize the same kink we shared in others.

Ethan quietly excused himself from the company of Juliette and her friends — again, completely effortlessly, without a hint of shame that he'd apparently added himself to their group for a few moments before going into a sudden retreat. Then he came back over to us, his face filled with jubilant victory.

'You see?' he said under his breath. 'You see how she was looking at me and Juliette?'

Brian and I nodded our full agreement, offering our peer reviews to confirm his theory.

Then, none other than Brooke joined our little group, asking us pointedly, 'What are you three miscreants talking about?'

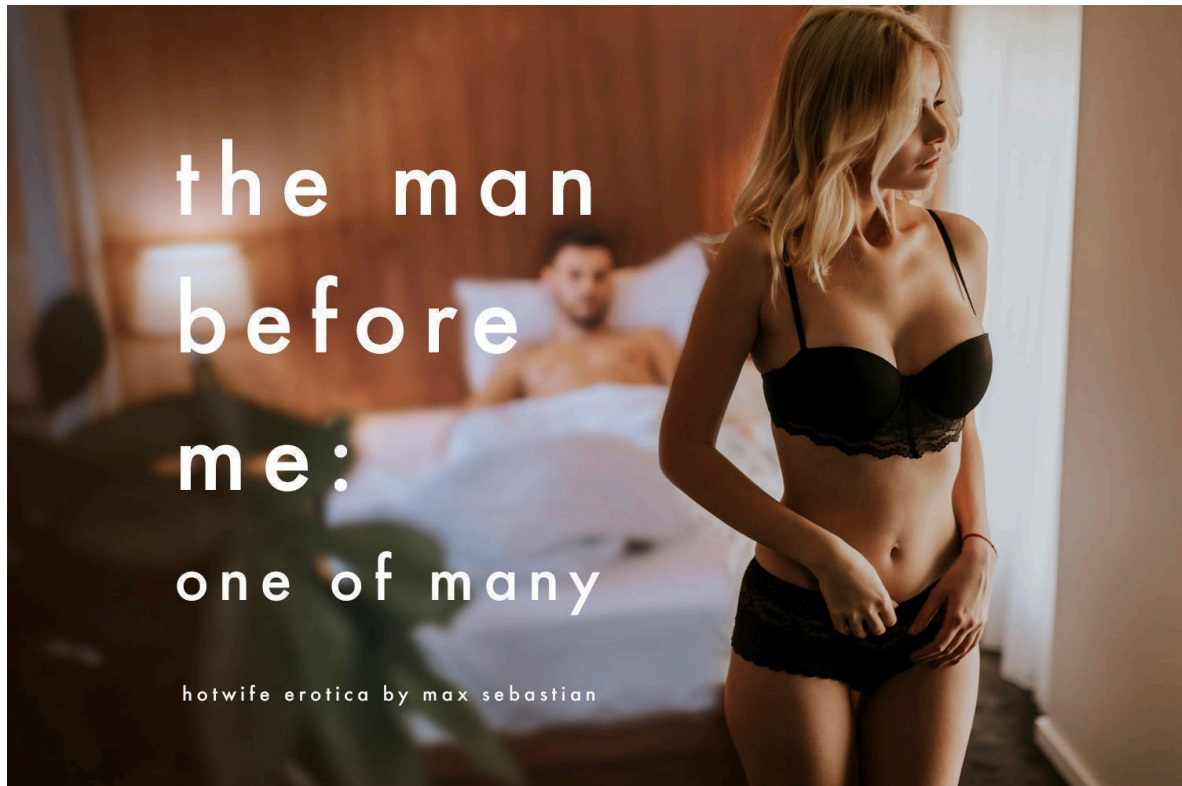
Takes one to know one, I thought to myself.

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The Man Before Me: One of Many (Ch.12)

by *Max Sebastian*



Evan asked us permission to talk to Brooke about our particular kink. He was subtle about doing it, though — he didn't just rush over there to divulge all, there were far too many people around.

This was still cuckolding we were talking about, after all. As they had chatted with him about it, Ethan had quickly understood that what Brian and I were into was not exactly accepted by the mainstream.

So it was much later that he finally went over to chat with Brooke, when Brian and I had almost forgotten he was going to do so.

Brian had gone off to mingle with other partygoers and keep his beautiful fiancée company for a while in the interim.

But now, the clock hands heading for their topmost position, my friend flashed his eyes at me from across the room to alert me. I glanced over to

see Ethan and Brooke sharing a quiet moment in the kitchen together.

We couldn't hear what they were saying to each other, but their body language was clear enough. Ethan was clearly trying to appear calm and unfazed about the information he was casually letting slip to Brooke. Brooke looked obviously intrigued from the get-go, and as Ethan spoke to her, her eyes widened and her jaw slowly dropped.

And Brian came back over to join me by the punch bowl. Brooke was gently blushing, her eyes blazing with interest.

'I guess our cat's out of the bag,' Brian said to me quietly, glancing around to see that we were far enough away from other partygoers to maintain discreet conversation.

'I don't think it'll go much further than this,' I replied. 'Look at her — you can tell she's interested in it.'

'Yeah, I think that's plain enough. But you can't tell if she's horrified or delighted by what she's hearing.'

We could see her looking around for us — and spotting us — as though she couldn't help it, given that Ethan must have been talking about us with her. Brian and I averted our gazes to avoid her picking up on the fact that we were also talking about her at that moment.

'I think she'll understand the sensitivity of this kind of information,' I assured my friend. 'She's not going to start denouncing us as perverts to the whole world.'

'Well, definitely not if she's like us,' Brian grinned. 'You think she is?'

I took a risk and glanced over at her. Brooke was still looking at us. Our eyes connected, and she gave me a somewhat bashful smile, blushing furiously. I flashed her a smile back that I hoped would seem reassuring, or supportive if it turned out she was uncomfortable with what Ethan was saying to her.

I took a step away from the punch bowl, trying to make it look to Brooke as though, if we had been earlier, we weren't talking about her now.

'My guess is, she's been given a lot to think about,' I said to Brian, and saw him glance Brooke's way briefly.

He seemed to get what I was saying, because then we were both casually sauntering away from the punch bowl as though we had other fish to fry.

He said quietly, 'We shouldn't just assume that because Ethan tells her about our particular brand of non-monogamy, she's going to instantly embrace it.'

Brian and I consciously made efforts to give Brooke space to deal with whatever Ethan had said to her, though we were both itching to talk to her, to see if she was, indeed, intrigued. But there were still plenty of people at the party, and Brian had an obligation to mingle and spend time with Jessie, while I was supposed to be hosting this whole thing with Juliette, so I had to spend time making sure everyone was happy and that the drinks were flowing as they should.

Past midnight, though, the dance floor — Brian and Jessie's living room, minus the rug so that the bare hardwood floor could aid dancing — became the main attraction. That took the pressure nicely off me as host, ensuring more and more people were happy and not necessarily requiring conversation or massive amounts of alcohol.

Juliette could even ask me if I was okay keeping an eye on things while she took to the dancefloor herself. That was a bonus — while I did my duty as host, I could quietly watch my wife dancing with a series of different men. I recognized several of them as ex-boyfriends she'd recently re-friended on Facebook, and I very much enjoyed how flirty she was with them.

All of them knew she was poly — that she was basically available for the taking, if they played their cards right.

So that proved plenty of distraction.

I didn't even particularly need to conceal my interest in what was going on, since after a certain point, most of the remaining partygoers were dancing and not paying attention to wallflowers like me.

But I nearly jumped out of my skin when a familiar voice suddenly piped up beside me: 'She's having a lot of fun dancing, huh?'

It was Brooke, of course. I hadn't even thought about her for a while. She was on her own, her boyfriends nowhere to be seen. Scratch that — just at that moment, I did notice Ethan among the movers and shakers. In fact, as one song ended and another got into the swing, Ethan managed to expertly step in to seek Juliette as his next dance partner.

'I like it when she has a lot of fun,' I said quietly to Brooke.

I glanced down at her and saw that blaze of intrigue in her eyes — along with a gentle blush that suggested some inner shame or turmoil to go along with her gentle excitement.

'Anyone would say you're the perfect husband,' the petite brunette said.

We stood side by side, clutching our drinks, watching the dance floor like football supporters watching a game from the sideline. Nobody else noticed or cared about our clear voyeurism.

'You like seeing Ethan having fun?' I asked her.

'I guess so,' she said. 'You know, I never really thought much about how he was feeling when he wasn't with me.'

'But now you see things differently?'

She gave me an odd glance — embarrassed, but also somehow thrilled. Nervously interested. 'Ethan told me you like Juliette to tell you everything she does when she's been dating someone else.'

'He's not wrong.'

'She tells you everything?'

I shrugged. 'Everything I can think to ask about.'

'Ethan said you and Juliette asked his permission.'

I smiled, chuckled. 'You poly folk are so very ethical about everything,' I said.

She grinned. 'Us poly folk? But you're one of us, aren't you?'

'Well, yes, I am now.'

'But Juliette saw other guys... before you two decided to try polyamory? And she told you everything that happened?'

I glanced around us — making sure the coast was still clear.

'How much did Ethan tell you?'

'That you're into 'cuckolding'. Is that how you say it? I never really heard about it before.'

'Seriously, and you're polyamorous?'

But I wasn't making fun of her. The truth was out, and the vibes she was giving off were not of judgmental reproach. It was very much the opposite.

'Ethan said Juliette slept with her ex-boyfriend in front of you. And you... enjoyed it.'

Brooke was blushing furiously as she said this. It was both startling and disturbing to me, while also offering that same strange thrill I'd experienced earlier as I was among people openly discussing or referring to Juliette dating other men as part of our new polyamorous lifestyle.

'Does this get us thrown out of the polyamorous fraternity?' I joked.

Brooke cracked a broad grin. 'I don't think so.'

She gave me a sidelong glance and then added, 'There's no requirement in the Fraternity to inform anyone about your personal secrets. Not unless it involves someone.'

We watched our other halves — or in Brooke's case, I guess, thirds? — dancing together, and it felt like we understood each other. Yet I could tell Brooke was still figuring out her feelings about this kind of thing.

I saw Ethan glance over toward us, and could tell he was aware of us watching, though he didn't necessarily want to make it obvious. Yet once

he was aware, he subtly adjusted how he was dancing with Juliette — taking hold of her, pulling her close, turning it into more of a sensual, seductive process instead of a purely innocent enjoyment of the music.

I heard Brooke catch her breath when we watched the two of them close in for a tender kiss between songs.

'Are you okay?' I quietly asked her.

She seemed to make an effort to restore her calm. 'I've seen him with other people before, of course,' she said. 'You know... at parties, or when they're on their way out to a date or something...'

'But you never paid it much attention before?' I inferred.

She shook her head. 'It just wasn't much of an issue, you know?'

'You're used to compartmentalizing.'

'Uh-huh.'

There were fewer people on the dance floor by now — it was getting late, I suppose, and folks were beginning to slip away to go home. It meant we could see more easily when Ethan had his hands on Juliette, and when she had her hands on him.

This was beyond the flirtation stage now, heading into the realms of mild foreplay. Naturally, I felt the warm tingle of arousal blossom inside me as I watched my wife gazing adoringly into another man's eyes, her hands all over his buff torso, her body pressed to his.

Beside me, Brooke said softly, 'Why does it make me want him so badly?'

I concealed a smile under my hand as I scratched a nonexistent itch on the bridge of my nose. I asked her quietly, 'How do you feel about her touching him?'

She said, 'I like it. I don't know why... I mean... she's beautiful. I want him to be happy, I like that she excites him. I want her to touch him. Is that weird?'

'No, not at all.'

'I never really watched one of my boyfriends with another woman before. Never even really thought about it...'

We watched Juliette and Ethan dancing so close, they seemed to collapse in on themselves like two celestial bodies colliding, helpless to prevent the gravitational forces pulling them to each other. Then they were kissing, so deeply this time, passionately, as though forgetting they were in the middle of a dance floor, in a party stuffed full of friends.

I heard Brooke quietly gasp, and felt my own body respond to the sight of my wife in such a clinch with another man, and felt like I knew how Brooke might be feeling.

'You okay?' I asked her.

'Oh yes,' she said, surprising me with her assured, confident tone.

'Should we leave them to it for a while?' I asked, my eyes locked on the sight of Ethan's hands wandering all over my wife's body.

But Brooke didn't answer me. I turned my head, and saw that she was on the move — surprising me yet again by boldly stepping forward, offering me a mischievous smirk before entering the fray on the dance floor.

I stood back and watched her approach Ethan and Juliette. Juliette looked uncertain for a split second, as though her initial instinct was that Brooke must be feeling jealous about her being with Ethan. But then I saw smiles break out all around, and the two women were laughing together, and then Brooke was dancing with them, as though their partnership was about to become a threesome right there in front of everybody.

I wondered if Ethan might take both of them home with him at the end of the evening. Maybe that was just my deviant mind at work, but I found the prospect of my sweet wife engaging in a threesome with Brooke sexy as hell.

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